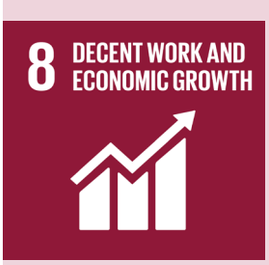
DE MONTFORT UNIVERSITY LEICESTER



EAP 1

5th EDITION

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Unit 1 The United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (lead-in)



SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

"More than ever before in human history, we share a common destiny. We can master it only if we face it together. And that, my friends, is why we have the United Nations". Kofi Annan, 7th UN Secretary General.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

This unit covers:

Speaking

- Brainstorming in groups
- Giving your opinions in group discussions
- Reacting to a lecture topic
- Preparing an academic presentation
- The structure and features of an academic presentation

Reading

- Skimming
- Scanning

Listening

- Listening for details in short lectures
- Note completion

DISCUSSION

a. What do you know about the United Nations? What is it? What is its purpose? Is your country a member of it?

b. Complete the quiz and compare your answers with a partner.

1. When was The United Nations formed?
   a. 1935 b. 1945 c. 1955 d. 1965

2. How many member states are there?
   a. 73 b. 103 c. 153 d. 193

3. Where is The United Nations headquarters?
   a. London b. Tokyo c. New York d. Madrid

4. How many official languages does the United Nations have?
   a. 1 b. 2 c. 4 d. 6

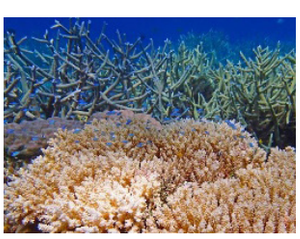
5. Approximately how many people are serving worldwide in United Nations peacekeeping operations?
   a. 30,000 b. 60,000 c. 90,000 d. 120,000

SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

Task 1- Discussion

a. Below, you can see pictures that relate to some of the world's most serious problems. Use these photos and your own ideas to brainstorm the following question in groups:

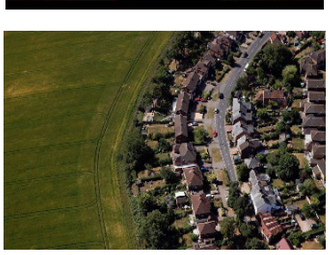
What do you think are the biggest problems in the world today?








Biggest problems in the world today

b. Compare your group's ideas with another group.

Task 2- Reading comprehension

In order to try to combat world problems, the United Nations established the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).

a. Read the information about the SDGs from the UN's website and answer questions 1-5 that follow.

Home | About | Campaigns | Goals | Take Action | Partnerships | News And Media | Learn More

The Sustainable Development Agenda



SDG REPORT 2018

On 1 January 2016, the 17 Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development — adopted by world leaders in September 2015 at an historic UN Summit — officially came into force. Over the next fifteen years, with these new Goals that universally apply to all, countries will mobilize efforts to end all forms of poverty, fight inequalities and tackle climate change, while ensuring that no one is left behind.

The SDGs build on the success of the Millennium Development Goals (MDGs) and aim to go further to end all forms of poverty. The new Goals are unique in that they call for action by all countries, poor, rich and middle-income to promote prosperity while protecting the planet. They recognize that ending poverty must go hand-in-hand with strategies that build economic growth and addresses a range of social needs including education, health, social protection, and job opportunities, while tackling climate change and environmental protection.

United Nations (2019) *The Sustainable Development Agenda.* Available at: https://www.un.org/sustainabledevelopment/development-agenda/ (Accessed: 28 June 2019).

1. What do the following numbers and dates refer to...?
   1st January 2016 *2030* *2015* *17* *fifteen years*

2. Why were the Sustainable development Goals developed?

3. How are the SDGs different to the MDGs?

4. Who is responsible for working towards the goals?

5. Is the protection of the environment more important than allowing countries' economies to grow?

Task 3- Vocabulary development

The reading text on the previous page contains a number of useful verbs that can be used to talk about solutions.

a. Find and highlight the following verbs in the text:

adopt	come into force	tackle
promote	recognise	address

b. Just by reading the text, what do you think is the meaning of each verb? Work with a partner. Don't use a dictionary.

c. Match the following definitions to the verbs above.

1. *If you [.....] an idea or a cause, you support or actively encourage it.*
2. *If you [.....] a problem or an issue, you decide how to deal with it.*
3. *If you [.....] a problem or a difficult task, you make a big effort to deal with it.*
4. *When new rules or laws [.....], they start to be used.*
5. *If you [.....] an idea, method or solution, you start to use it.*
6. *If you [.....] a problem, you accept that it is real and important.*

d. Complete the gaps with a suitable verb from above.

1. Even though it is a huge problem, it is really important to ..... climate change as quickly as possible.
2. The new tax regulations will ..... next week.
3. The public must ..... the seriousness of the problems we are facing.
4. Sometimes, when international students begin studying in the UK, they have to ..... a new way of learning.
5. The organisation is working with young people to ..... awareness of mental health issues and well-being.
6. Although the new solution will help a little, it does not completely ..... the problem.

Task 4- Building knowledge

a. Below, you can see the icons for each of the 17 Sustainable Development Goals and their titles. Choose 3 of the SDGs and for each goal, answer the following questions:

1. What do you think is the goal's aim?
2. Which countries/areas of the world do you think this goal impacts?
3. Do you think it will be easy to achieve this goal?



Task 5- Short Lectures (Part 1)

You are going to listen to a short talk by Dr Andrew Reeves, a Senior Lecturer in Energy and Sustainable Development from the faculty of technology at DMU. He is talking about the United Nations' Sustainable Development Goals.

a. Listen to the introduction (Part 1) of the talk and answer the following questions:

1. What are the three things that Dr Reeves will discuss in the lecture?

2. What does the lecturer ask you to think about?

b. Discuss the following with a partner: What are the biggest challenges that your country faces?

Task 6- Short Lectures (Part 2)

a. Before you listen to Part 2 of the talk, check that you know the word class, meaning and stress pattern of the following words:

agenda	accomplish	eradicate	biodiversity
innovation	infrastructure	collaborate	

b. Discuss the following questions with a partner.

1. What would you like to see **eradicated**, and why?
2. What would you personally like to **accomplish** in your lifetime?
3. Can you think of any threats to **biodiversity**?
4. What do you think have been some of the most important **innovations** of the past fifty years?
5. Why is good **infrastructure** important?
6. When was the last time you had to **collaborate** with someone? What did you have to collaborate on?

Task 7- Listening for details

a. Listen to **Part 2** of the lecture and answer the following questions:

1. According to the lecturer, what are the aims of the Sustainable Development Goals?

2. What are the three different types of goals?

3. Why is De Montfort University interested in the SDGs?

b. Compare your answers with a partner.

c. In Part 3 of the lecture, Dr Reeves talks about the challenges of achieving the goals. Look at the student's notes below and listen to **Part 3**. Complete the notes with no more than three words for each answer.

- World challenges are <u>not</u> easy to solve; needs <u>collaboration</u> between different groups of people.

e.g. [1]_____ in a city

<u>Benefits</u>

- Reduces number of cars → [2]_____
- Improves [3]_____ → saves the government money

= Logical solution but CHALLENGING because it needs collaboration between:

1. [4]_____
2. [5]_____
3. [6]_____

Task 8- Reacting to the topic

You are going to discuss some questions related to what you have learnt in today's class.

a. Read questions 1-4 below and make some notes on your ideas.

1. Do you think the development of the SDGs was a good idea? Why, or why not?
2. Do you think the world needs the SDGs for positive change to happen around the world?
3. There are 17 SDGs. Do you think there are any world issues that are not addressed?
4. Do you think we will be able to achieve the goals by 2030?

b. Use your notes to discuss your ideas in small groups. Make sure to use the phrases from the Useful Language box below.

Useful Language: Giving your opinion

To me...	I take the view that...
I believe...	In my view...
I think...	It is my view that...
In my opinion...	I have to say that...
As far as I'm concerned...	It seems (obvious/clear/evident) to me that...
What I think is...	I'd say that...

Academic Presentations (1)



Task 1- Discussion

a. An important element of most university courses is your ability to deliver an academic presentation. Read the following comments made by 7 university students and decide whether you agree or disagree with their point of view.



"If you deliver a presentation confidently, it doesn't matter if your information is poor". Elena, Graphic Design.



"Doing a presentation really shows your teacher how much of your topic you understand". James, Pharmacy.



"Presentations are easy because you can just read from your notes and your slides". Maria, Nursing.



"Presentations are similar to essays only you are talking rather than writing". Mila, Cyber Security.



"I don't think I should have to do a presentation. It isn't fair on students who get very nervous". Alex, Fine Art.



"I don't mind speaking in front of my peers. If I make language mistakes, who cares?". Germaine, Business Studies.



I usually speak English with poor grammar so I always memorize my speech word for word. I know I'll get better marks that way. Raj, Mechanical Engineering.

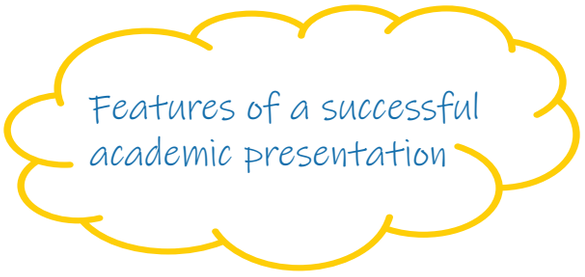
b. Discuss your answers in small groups.

Task 2- Features of a successful academic presentation

a. What are the features of a successful academic presentation? Brainstorm your ideas in groups. Make sure to include ideas on the areas in the yellow box below.

body language the ideas the structure use of language use of your voice

considerations for your audience linking your ideas use of visuals research



b. Choose 2 of the areas from the yellow box above and present your ideas to the rest of the class.

Structuring an academic presentation

a. Much like an essay, an academic presentation follows a clear structure with an introduction, main body and conclusion. Read the following information on the structure and content of an academic presentation.

The Introduction should...	
Content	• Greet the audience + introduce yourself • State the purpose of your presentation and say why this topic is important • Briefly explain your structure + timing • Mention questions (when would you like the audience to ask)
Useful Language	* Today, I'd like to talk to you about... * I shall be covering (three) main areas. * Should you have any questions, I'd be happy to answer them at the end.

The Main Body should...	
Content	• Give details and supporting points of your ideas (be selective) • Refer to visuals such as PowerPoint slides • Draw attention to important points • Use signposting phrases to link your ideas and transition to a new section
Useful Language	* Let's look at the first point. * I should add that... * I should emphasise that... * As I mentioned earlier... * That covers everything I'd like to say about... * Finally, I would like to turn to...

The Conclusion should...	
Content	• Review the purpose • Summarise the main points • Come to a clear end • Give a final 'take-away' message (what do you want your audience to remember?) • Thank the audience
Useful Language	* Let's summarise briefly what we've looked at. * To conclude... * Many thanks for your attention...

The Question & Answer should...	
Content	• Invite questions • Answer questions clearly and sincerely • Show understanding of your topic (don't worry if you are unsure of an answer)
Useful Language	* Are there any questions? * Do you mean...? * I'm sorry, I'm afraid I'm not sure. I will find out for you.

Academic presentation assignment

As part of this course, you will need to deliver an individual 5-7 minute presentation to your teacher and some of your classmates.

By completing this assignment you will gain experience of:

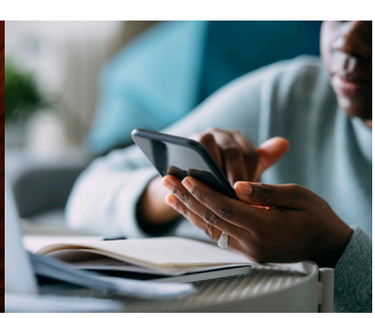
- *presenting in English*
- *using appropriate signposting phrases to link your sections and ideas*
- *researching*
- *evaluating*
- *reflecting on your own learning*
- *using your voice to maintain the audience's interest*
- *producing and using visuals such as PowerPoint slides*

Task 1- Presentation topic preparation (i)

a. Complete the questionnaire about language learning on the next page. Your answers to these questions will serve as the starting point for your presentation, so answer honestly.

b. Compare your answers to the questionnaire with a partner. What are your strengths? Which are your weak areas?





My Language Learning Questionnaire

For each of the statements below, choose a number from **1 to 5** to show how true the statement is for you. Don't be too hard on yourself! You do not need to add up your score.

1 Untrue of me **2** Fairly untrue of me **3** Neutral **4** Fairly true of me **5** True of me

Number

Listening

1. I can understand the main point in short, clear, simple messages and announcements. ☐
2. I can understand extended speech and lectures and follow an argument if the topic is reasonably familiar. ☐
3. I have no difficulty in understanding any kind of spoken language. ☐

Speaking

1. In discussions, I can usually understand enough to keep the conversation going. ☐
2. I take an active part in discussion about familiar topics, and give reasons for my views. ☐
3. I can use language effectively for both social and academic purposes. ☐

Reading

1. I can find specific, predictable information in texts such as advertisements, menus and timetables and I can understand short, simple personal messages. ☐
2. I can read articles and reports about contemporary problems and understand the writer's attitudes or viewpoints. ☐
3. It's easy for me to read nearly all forms of the written language, including linguistically complex texts such as manuals and specialised articles. ☐

Writing

1. I can write simple connected text on topics which are familiar or of personal interest. ☐
2. I can write an essay or report, giving information or reasons to support my opinions. ☐
3. I can write clear, smoothly-flowing text in an appropriate style and with an effective, logical structure. ☐

Vocabulary

1. I know enough vocabulary for everyday things such as asking for information or directions. ☐
2. I think my vocabulary is adequate for most everyday purposes. ☐
3. I have a wide vocabulary and I can use specialist terminology connected to my field of study. ☐

Pronunciation

1. People usually understand me when I try to speak. ☐
2. I make some mistakes but I usually manage to communicate my message. ☐
3. My pronunciation never causes communication problems. ☐

Task 2- Presentation topic preparation (ii)

You are going to discuss the following discussion question in small groups:

"How can you improve your English yourself on this Pre-Sessional course?"

a. To prepare for this discussion, complete the table below with as many ideas as you can think of to help improve your English. Pay particular attention to your weak areas. Make sure that you only write things that you would be comfortable doing yourself and you can do easily in the next four weeks.

Listening	**Speaking**
Reading	**Writing**
Vocabulary	**Pronunciation**

b. Discuss your ideas in small groups and do the following:

1. Share your ideas- do you suggest the same ideas?
2. Add any new ideas that you hear about to your table.
3. As a group, decide which suggestions will be the most practical / effective?

Unit 2 Decent Work and Economic Growth (lead-in)





"Economic growth doesn't mean anything if it leaves people out". Jack Kemp, American Politician.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

This unit covers:

Reading

- Skimming a textbook article
- An introduction to summaries
- Recognising sources
- Identifying key points and supporting evidence
- Analysing a text

Vocabulary

- Language of cause-effect
- Business terms

Writing

- Structure of cause-effect essays
- Using sources to support ideas
- In-text referencing and citation
- Analysing an essay question
- Plagiarism

Listening

- Listening for details

DISCUSSION

1. Complete facts (a-g) with a statistic from the box.

a. The number of people in the world in ***informal employment*** in non-agricultural sectors is .....

b. The number of the world's youth who are not in education, employment or training is .....

c. The number of deaths in the workplace (based on data from 55 countries) is .....

d. The number of ***non-fatal injuries*** in workplaces (based on data from 55 countries) is .....

e. The increase in the world's ***labour productivity*** in 2018 (the highest since 2010) was .....

f. The ***median hourly gender pay gap*** (based on 62 countries) is .....

g. The median gender pay gap in managerial and professional occupations (based on 62 countries) is .....

3 in 100,000	more than half	20%	one fifth
889 in 100,000	12%	2.1%	

2. Which statistic is the most shocking to you?

Adapted from: United Nations (2020) *Sustainable Development Goals knowledge Platform: Sustainable Development Goal 8* Available at: https://sustainabledevelopment.un.org/sdg8. (Accessed: 30 March 2020).

Causes and Effects



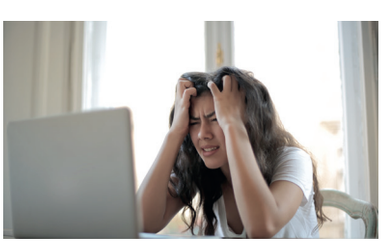
Task 1- Vocabulary

a. Look at the pictures 1-5 below.

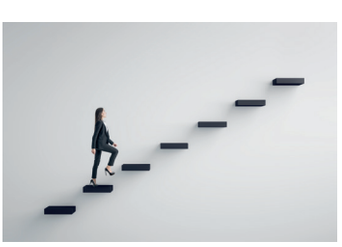
1



2



3



4



5

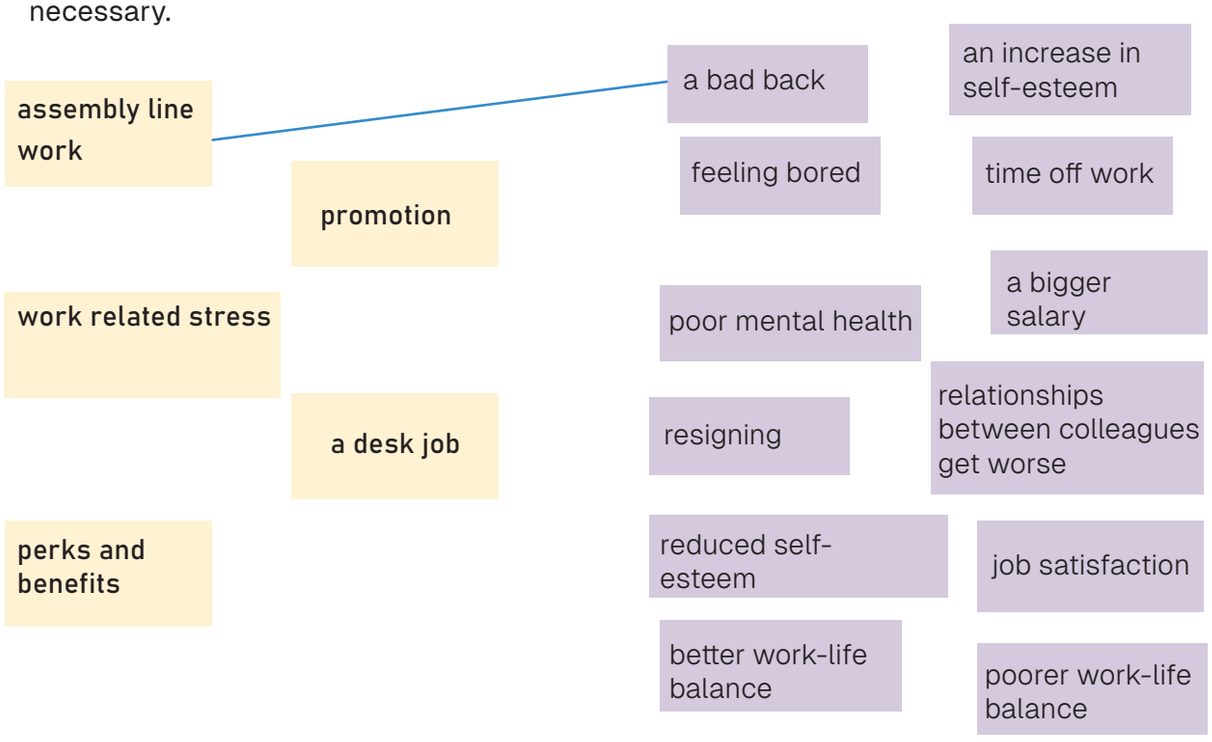


b. Match the noun phrases in the box below with pictures 1-5.

assembly line work promotion a desk job
work related stress perks and benefits

Task 2- Making connections

a. Look at the causes and effects below. Connect the causes (yellow boxes) with all if its effects (in purple). Each effect can be used more than once. Use your dictionary only if necessary.



b. Compare your answers with a partner.

Task 3- Expressing cause and effect

a. Read the following explanation of useful language for expressing cause and effect.

Useful Language: Expressing cause and effect

(v) Cause (something)
Working on an assembly line can cause a bad back.
Promotion causes an increase in self-esteem.

(v) Cause (something to happen)
Working on an assembly line may cause workers to have a bad back.
Promotion causes employees to have an increase in self-esteem.

(v) Result in / lead to (+ object)
Working on an assembly line may result in a bad back.
Promotion leads to an increase in self-esteem.

(v) Result in / lead to (+ verb-ing)
Working on an assembly line can result in having a bad back.
Promotion leads to (employees) having an increase in self-esteem.

expression + effect

(prep) As a result of / because of (+ noun or noun phrase with verb-ing)
Workers may get a bad back as a result of working on an assembly line.
Employees could have an increase in their self-esteem because of a promotion.
As a result of working on an assembly line, workers may get a bad back.
Because of a promotion, employees could have an increase in their self-esteem.

(v) Result from (+ object)
A bad back results from assembly line work.
An increase in self-esteem results from a promotion.

(v) Result from (+ verb-ing)
A bad back results from working on an assembly line.
An increase in self-esteem results from having a promotion.

} expression + cause

b. Look back at the connections you made in Task 2a. Use the expressions from the 'Useful Language' box to write sentences which show the causes and effects.

1. .....
2. .....
3. .....
4. .....
5. .....
6. .....
7. .....
8. .....

c. Discuss your sentences with a partner. Add more information by saying HOW the cause leads to the effect.

Example

Student A: *I think working on an assembly line can cause a bad back. This is because an assembly line worker will probably stand in the same position for a long time, which could get very uncomfortable.*

Student B: *Yes, I think so too. I also think assembly line work leads to...*

Task 4- Preparing to read

a. You are going to read an article called ***'The effects of technology on labour markets'.*** To prepare for the topics presented, look at statements 1-5. Do you agree or disagree?

1. The introduction of technology to a job is beneficial.
2. Working with technology plays a major role in making a job more interesting.
3. Technology in the workplace makes workers redundant.
4. Working with technology can affect the body and mind.
5. The introduction of technology leads to making a job safer.

b. Explain the reasons for your opinions in small groups. Try to use the words and phrases highlighted above.

Task 5- Vocabulary

a. Use your dictionary to answer these questions:

1. A labour market is a place where you can go if you need to find a job. True or false?
2. If there is disruption in a society or a company, is this good or bad, or possibly both?
3. If something diminishes, does it get bigger or smaller?
4. What kind of goods are capital goods?
5. What is a phenomenon? What is the plural of phenomenon?
6. Do you think it is important for workers to have bargaining power with their bosses? How can workers' unions help with this?
7. If you decentralise your company, do you have one single head or a number of departmental heads?
8. If your company outsources some of its work, what does it do?

Task 6- Skimming a textbook article

You are now going to read part of an article about the effects of technology on labour markets.

a. Quickly read the article on the next page and match terms 1, 2 and 3 with definitions a, b and c.

Term	Definition
1. *Disruption*	a. *Reduced need for workers because of advances in technology*
2. *Diminishing role of labour*	b. *Moving away from large companies and formation of smaller ones*
3. *Decentralising of economic activity*	c. *Positive and negative changes to jobs and working conditions*

b. Read the article again more closely. Are the following statements **True**, **False** or **Not Given**?

1. Disruption can have both positive and negative results.
2. Patterns of disruption do not affect developing economies.
3. Technological unemployment has led many people to set up their own businesses.
4. The full impact of the three effects is not yet known for certain.

Task 7- Noticing further language of effects

a. Look at the cause and effect language in red in the first paragraph. Highlight more examples of ways of talking about cause and effect in the rest of the extract.

b. Complete the boxes below with the examples you highlighted and those in red from the first paragraph.

VERBS	ADVERBS	NOUN / NOUN PHRASES

The effects of technology on labour markets

1. There are three effects of technology—especially digital innovation—and globalisation on labour markets. The first effect is *disruption*. This means that jobs may be moved to different places where costs are lower, or they may change in a way that will force workers to learn to do different tasks. Some jobs may disappear and new ones may be created. Disruption can be seen in any healthy economy, because it is the result of markets responding to changing conditions. Although the effects of disruption can be very hard for individual people or communities, its effects for workers are generally positive, because it can lead to the replacement of old jobs with new ones that are safer, less physically hard and more interesting to do. This has been true for the average worker in rich economies for many years up to the present, but less true for developing economies' (Rodrik, 2015). Nowadays however, patterns of disruption are changing and creating new groups of winners and losers, and as a result, we can no longer see these patterns as positive in all cases. In addition, disruption is believed to be growing in intensity.

2. The second effect is a *diminishing role of labour*. Technology has made capital goods cheaper and this has led to loss of jobs as machines replace people. As a result, in both rich and poor countries, less of the national income is in the form of wages for workers and more is in the form of profits for companies. Some analysts believe that this, in combination with the increasing disruption described above, will lead to large-scale technological unemployment, which is the loss of jobs caused by technological change. This is a very worrying possibility for the developing world, where the size of the work-age population is expected to increase by half a billion people by 2030. Another possible consequence could be that inequality will increase.

3. The third effect is *decentralising of economic activity*. This means that individuals begin to set up their own small businesses instead of working for the big corporations. This phenomenon is a part of both the digital economy and globalization, where we see firms in fields such as marketing and accounting outsourcing work to other companies. This has both positive and negative effects on terms of employment. A positive effect is an increase in flexibility as customers can change to new vendors if they are not satisfied. A negative effect is a reduction in worker's unions and resultant loss of workers' bargaining power.

4. Although there is good evidence for each of the three effects, it is not certain how quickly they will happen or how powerful their effect may be. For instance, estimates on the numbers of jobs that are at risk from automation in the not too distant future vary from 9 to 47 percent for OECD economies*. Fewer estimates exist for the developing world, meaning that the possible range could be even greater. In another example, a year ago the World Bank reported evidence that labour markets in the developing world have more high and low-level jobs and fewer intermediate level jobs than in the past, the same pattern that we see in industrialized economies. However, more recent analysis reveals no such pattern (Maloney and Molina, 2016).

* Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) International economic organisation of 34 countries, founded on 30 September 1961 to stimulate economic progress and world trade.

References

Maloney, W. and Molina, C. (2017) 'Are Automation And Trade of Developing Country Labor Markets, Too?', *World Bank Group*. Available at: http://documents.worldbank.org/curated/en/869281482170996446/pdf/WPS7922.pdf (Accessed: 03 March 2020).

Rodrik, D. (2015) 'Work And Human Development In A Deindustrializing World'. *United Nations Development Programme*. Available at: http://hdr.undp.org/sites/default/files/rodrik_hdr_2015_final.pdf (Accessed: 31 March 2020).

Adapted from- Chandy, L. (2017) *The Future of Work in the Developing World*. Available at: https://www.brookings.edu/research/the-future-of-work-in-the-developing-world/ (Accessed: 31 March 2020).

An introduction to summaries

It is very useful to write a summary of articles, book chapters and lectures. Summaries help you to remember information you have read, and to quote from sources in your own writing.

A summary should:

- Be short
- Give only the main ideas, no details or examples.
- Use your own words, not words from the original text.

Task 8- Summaries

a. Here are three summaries of paragraph 2 from the article you have just read. Which summary do you think is the best, and why? What is wrong with the others? Compare your answers with a partner.

Summary 1

'Diminishing role of labour' means that workers become less important than machines. Technology has made capital goods cheaper and so people lose their jobs as machines replace people. As a result, in both rich and poor countries less of the national income is in the form of wages for workers and more is in the form of profits for companies. This is worrying because it will make the developing world more unequal (Chandy, 2017).

Summary 2

According to Chandy (2017), technology has led to loss of jobs and income for workers and more profit for companies. Large scale unemployment resulting from lack of technical skills is a serious threat to developing countries with work-age populations that are expected to rise steeply over the coming decade.

Summary 3

Capital machines (machines a company uses to manufacture the goods it produces) are getting cheaper because of new technology and this means that lots of people are losing their jobs and in both rich and poor countries, and while workers are getting poorer, companies are getting richer. Technical unemployment means unemployment caused by advances in technology. This is expected by some experts to rise in the next decade, which is very worrying for countries in the developing world where there will be large populations of work age people in 2030 (Chandy, 2017).

Using Sources and Referencing



Task 1- Discussion

a. Answer the following questions in small groups:

1. Why is it important to use academic sources in your university assignments to support your ideas?
2. What would happen if you didn't use any academic sources in your assignments to support your ideas?
3. What kind of academic sources could you use?
4. Is there anything that would be inappropriate to use?

b. Answer questions 1-5 about ***collusion***.

collusion

1. Do you know anyone who copied their friend's work and said it was their own?
2. Has anyone ever copied your work and passed it off as their own? If yes, how did you feel? If no, would you let someone copy if they asked?
3. If you copied another student's work, do you think your tutor would ever find out?
4. Why do you think some students copy other students' assignments?
5. What do you think ***collusion*** is?

c. Discuss your answers in small groups.

d. Answer questions 1-7 about ***plagiarism***.

plagiarism

1. Do you know anyone who has ever downloaded a ready-made essay from the Internet and used it for their course assignment?
2. In your country, is it OK to **copy and paste** a big section from a book, an article or a lecture and not say who originally said it? What about in British universities?
3. In your country, is it OK to **copy and paste** a small sentence from a book, an article or a lecture and not say who originally said it? What about in British universities?
4. If you copy something small or big from a friend, a book, an article etc. in a British university and do not say who originally said it, do you think your tutors will know easily?
5. If you are found guilty of copying, what do you think the consequences will be?
6. What do you think ***plagiarism*** is?

e. Discuss your answers in small groups.

Task 2- Plagiarism

a. Check that you know the meaning of each word in the box. Then read the information and advice about plagiarism. Complete gaps 1-10 using words from the box.

in-text reference	Reference List	kidnapper	support	acknowledging
published	collusion	submit	quotation marks	paraphrasing

The word 'plagiarism' originates from Latin where it meant [1] '..... '.

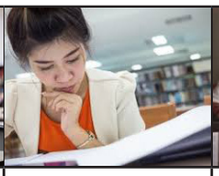
Plagiarism covers a wide range of situations from copying a whole piece of work to copying a small sentence without [2] ..... who originally said it and when.

It is OK to use information from the internet, books, articles and journals etc. to [3] ..... . ideas but the student MUST acknowledge the source by using a [4] ..... which contains the original author and the year it was [5] ..... . In addition, if the student wants to use the exact wording, [6] ..... must be used. However, it is better to use your own words, structure and grammar whilst keeping the same idea; this is known as [7] ..... . You must also include a page number in your in-text reference.

As well as including an in-text reference with the cited information in the paragraph, the student must also include a full reference in the [8] '.....', which contains more information such as the name of the book, website, journal name and article title and other details.

Within plagiarism, another academic offense is [9] ..... This is when two or more students work together and [10] ..... the same piece of work but pass it off as their own. In addition, collusion could be when a student uses another student's work as their own. In both cases, all students involved can be punished.

b. Are the following students guilty of plagiarism or collusion? Discuss your answers with a partner.

					
1. Sarah and Carlos discussed their assignment together and submitted different essays, although the ideas were basically the same.	2. Ali copied several short paragraphs from several websites and linked them together with his own words without stating where they came from.	3. Eun cut and pasted from several websites and did not acknowledge them in the text but she included a reference list at the end.	4. Nathan wrote a research report which used data his classmate collected.	5. Emily found some information on an anonymous website and used the idea as her own in her presentation.	6. Arianna read an article and used its ideas in her essay in her own words and did not include a reference to the source in her text.

Task 3- Knowing when you need support

If you give your **opinion** in an assignment, you must provide evidence from academic sources as support of your ideas. However, if you present an idea that is common knowledge or a fact, you don't need to provide support.

a. Imagine you are using sentences 1-6 below in a piece of academic writing on the topic of the 'minimum wage'. Decide if you would need to provide academic support.

1. The current minimum wage in the UK is £12.21 per hour for those aged 21 and over.
2. Charities and trade unions argue that earning the minimum wage is not enough to cover the real cost of living in the UK.
3. The UK government reviews its minimum wage annually, with changes coming into effect every April.
4. The purpose of the minimum wage is to ensure that workers are paid a basic, liveable wage to prevent exploitation and poverty.
5. The minimum wage helps to lift low-income families out of poverty.
6. The minimum wage can increase productivity because it provides workers with a greater incentive to accept and stay in a job.

Task 4- Methods of citation

a. In order to support your ideas with evidence from academic sources, you can use a ***paraphrase***, a ***summary*** or a ***direct quotation***. Match each of these citation types with the definitions below.

Citation type	Definition
	Writing the main ideas of a text or parts of a text, in as few of your own words as possible.
	Repeating one or two sentences of an author's exact words and putting them within quotation marks.
	Choosing one or two sentences from the original source and rewriting them in your own words with different grammar, vocabulary and structure, while keeping the meaning the same.

b. When would you use each of the techniques? (e.g. when would a direct quotation be better than using a paraphrase etc.?)

c. Read the following paragraph from an article on minimum wage and answer the questions that follow.

Although the minimum wage applies in most countries, there is always debate whenever it is adjusted. Increasing the minimum wage is expected to improve the living standard of low-income workers. However, firms can respond to an increase in the minimum wage by cutting back on their labor force to cope with the increase in labor costs. As a result, there can be an unintended disemployment effect on low-wage workers that minimum wages aim to protect.

Nguyen, C. V. (2025) 'The Impact of Minimum Wages on Employment: Evidence From a Lower Middle-Income Country', *Developing Economies*, 63(2), pp.137–182. https://doi.org/10.1111/deve.12419.

1. What kind of source is the article from?

2. What do some companies do when the minimum wage of workers is increased? Why do they do it?

d. Decide if the following citations are a ***direct quotation***, a ***paraphrase*** or a ***summary*** of the article extract.

Citation type	
	'Firms can respond to an increase in the minimum wage by cutting back on their labor force to cope with the increase in labor costs' (Nguyen, 2025, p. 137).
	According to Nguyen (2025), increasing the minimum wage should improve the living standard of low-income workers. However, some of these workers may actually lose their jobs as a result of companies trying to mitigate against increased costs in labour.
	Nguyen (2025, p. 137) states that due to increased costs in labour when the minimum wage increases, companies could respond by reducing their labour force.

e. If you write someone else's ideas, you must include an in-text reference. Look at the ***in-text references*** in the previous task and answer the following questions:

1. What information do you need to include in the in-text reference of a paraphrase and a direct quotation?
2. What information do you not need when giving a summary?
3. There are three methods used to integrate an in-text reference and its citation. What are they?

Task 5- Correcting in-text references

a. Look at the following extract and its source and answer the questions that follow:

Source:

Nuworsu, E. K. and Katare, B. (2025) 'How does increasing the minimum wage affect household food insecurity?' *Journal of the Agricultural & Applied Economics Association*, 4(3), pp. 391–404. https://doi.org/10.1002/jaa2.70019

Extract from page 392:

The effects of higher minimum wages on household food insecurity can have significant ramifications.

1. What kind of academic source is the article from?
2. Who wrote it?
3. In your own words, what is the extract talking about?

b. Read the direct quotations and paraphrases (1-7) below and decide if the in-text references are correctly formatted by writing 'yes' or 'no' in the column. If an in-text reference is incorrectly formatted, change it so that it is correct.

Citation	Correct formatting?
1. 'The effects of higher minimum wages on household food insecurity can have significant ramifications' (Nuworsu and Katare, 2025).	
2. As stated by Nuworsu, E. K. and Katare, B. (2025, p. 392), 'the effects of higher minimum wages on household food insecurity can have significant ramifications'.	
3. Higher minimum wages may have serious repercussions for household food insecurity (Nuworsu and Katare, 2025).	
4. Nuworsu and Katare (2025, p. 392) state that higher minimum wages may have serious repercussions for household food insecurity.	
5. According to (Nuworsu and Katare, 2025, p. 392), the effects of higher minimum wages on household food insecurity can have significant ramifications.	
6. 'The effects of higher minimum wages on household food insecurity can have significant ramifications' (Nuworsu and Katare, 2025, p.392).	
7. Nuworsu and Katare believe that higher minimum wages may have serious repercussions for household food insecurity (2025, p. 392).	

Task 6- Reflection

a. Discuss the following questions in small groups:

1. Does your country have a minimum wage? If yes, what is it? Do you think it is enough to live on?
2. Why do you think some countries choose not to have a minimum wage?
3. Why do you think there is a lot of debate each year when the minimum wage is adjusted? Who is affected by the adjustment?

Cause and Effect Essays



Task 1- Building knowledge

a. You are going to read an example cause and effect essay on the topic of 'child labour'. Before you read it, guess the most likely answer to questions (1-4) with a partner.

1. How many children today are child labourers?
   a. less than 50 million b. 100 million c. 150 million d. more than 200 million

2. How many child labourers are below 10 years old?
   a. 38 million b. 56 million c. 73 million d. 90 million

3. Where in the world is the highest number of child labourers?
   a. Sub-Saharan Africa b. South-East Asia c. The Middle East d. South America

4. Where do most children work?
   a. in factories b. on farms c. in domestic service d. building sites

5. Children often help in the production of the items below. What are they?






Adapted from: The World Counts (2020) *From the Sweat of our Children.* Available at: https://www.theworldcounts.com/stories/Child-Labor-Facts-and-Statistics (Accessed: 06 April 2020).

Task 2- Discussion

a. Discuss the following in groups.

1. Why do you think children around the world often have to go to work?

2. What do you think the effects of child labour might be for the children involved? Think about education, social life and possible health problems.

3. Do you think it would be realistic to ban child labour? Why/why not?

Task 3- Example Cause and Effect Essay

a. Quickly skim the cause and effect essay. Does it mention any of the ideas you discussed in Task 2?

b. What ideas does it mention that you did not discuss?

Discuss the causes and effects related to the use of child labour around the world

1. Child labour can be defined as work that is damaging to the physical, emotional and educational development of children (International Labour Organization, 2020). In 2019, more than 200 million children worldwide were involved in such work. Children are involved in the production of industrial crops such as cotton and rubber, and food crops such as coffee and vegetables (TheWorldCounts, 2020). In addition, child labour is involved at all stages in the production of clothes (Thieuws and Overeem, 2014). Child labour occurs in countries where unemployment is rife and people live below the poverty line. Therefore, the income that children earn is more important to the family than sending a child to school. This essay will discuss the social and physical effects of unregulated employment on the lives of the children involved.

2. Children who work during childhood often suffer from social and developmental problems (International Labour Rights Forum, 2013). The need to work often leads to children being unable to go to school. This results in a lack of opportunity for younger children to play and for teenagers to form close relationships with their peers. This in turn can result in the children experiencing isolation and depression. Children who have been deprived of interaction with other children may grow up to be insecure adults with emotional problems. According to the International Labour Rights Forum (2013), if teenagers are required to work more than twenty hours a week, they are in danger of developing antisocial behaviour such as aggression and drug taking. Thus, isolation from peers and lack of possibility to develop friendships contributes to long term emotional problems for children who are forced to work long hours.

3. Children who work from an early age may also be at risk physically. The International Labour Organization (2020) estimates that around 22,000 children are killed in work related accidents each year. The causes of these deaths include burns, electrocution and falls. Other children may suffer illness or injury because they are required to work in unsafe and insanitary conditions. These include working with hazardous chemicals or fire, working in damp or dusty conditions and with inadequate and badly maintained tools. Workplaces may be too hot or too cold, and the children may have to work long hours (International Labour Organization, 2020). Poor safety and health standards, then, are significant causes of death, illness and injury.

4. In conclusion, this essay has discussed the negative effects of child labour. Because of working during childhood, education and social development are negatively affected, and the child's physical health and safety are endangered. It is thought however, that a total ban on child labour would simply result in more poverty and suffering. What is needed is stricter control of the companies and individuals who employ children, to ensure that they comply with safety regulations and ensure that children are allowed time for play, rest and education.

480 words

References

International Labour Organization (2020) *What is Child Labour?.* Available at: https://www.ilo.org/ipec/facts/lang--en/index.htm (Accessed: 06 April 2020).

International Labour Rights Forum (2013) *Developmental Effects of Child Labor.* Available at: https://laborrights.org/blog/201109/developmental-effects-child-labor (Accessed: 06 April 2020).

Thieuws, M. and Overeem, P. (2014) *Fact Sheet: Child labour in the textile & garment industry.* Available at: https://www.somo.nl/fact-sheet-child-labour-focus-on-the-role-of-buying-companies/ (Accessed: 12 April 2020).

TheWorldCounts (2020) *From the Sweat of our Children.* Available at: https://www.theworldcounts.com/stories/Child-Labor-Facts-and-Statistics (Accessed: 06 April 2020).

Task 4- Essay Structure

In longer essays, it is possible to fully discuss the causes and effects of a subject. However, in shorter essays, in order to develop your ideas, focusing on one aspect (causes **or** effects) is more appropriate.

Structure 1
Introduction
Cause 1
Cause 2
Conclusion

Structure 2
Introduction
Effect 1
Effect 2
Conclusion

a. Look again at the essay and answer questions 1-5.

1. Does the essay focus on the *causes* or *effects* of child labour?
2. Where in the essay does the writer mention the causes of child labour?
3. Look at the introduction. Highlight the following aspects:
   - the causes of child labour
   - the ideas that will be mentioned in the main body (thesis statement)
   - a definition of 'child labour'
   - the number of children working
   - the industries that children work in

   } background information
4. Do the main body paragraphs explain the ideas briefly or fully?
5. Look at the conclusion. Highlight the following aspects:
   - the ideas that were mentioned in the essay (summary)
   - an opinion
   - a suggestion

Task 5- Recognising sources in academic writing

It is important in academic essays to support your ideas with information from academic sources. If your ideas are supported, the reader will trust your ideas more. If you have some information *(a citation)* from an academic book, journal, website or magazine, you must acknowledge this in your essay by using an *in-text reference.*

a. Look at an example citation from the essay introduction. What information is needed in the in-text reference?

citation

Child labour can be defined as work that is damaging to the physical, psychological and educational development of children (ILO, 2020).

in-text reference

b. Compare the citation from the essay with the original source below. The author did not copy the information exactly into their essay. What did the author change? What did they keep the same?

Original source 1

The term 'child labour' is often defined as work that deprives children of their childhood, their potential and their dignity, and that is harmful to physical and mental development. It refers to work that:

- is mentally, physically, socially or morally dangerous and harmful to children; and/or
- interferes with their schooling by: depriving them of the opportunity to attend school; obliging them to leave school prematurely; or requiring them to attempt to combine school attendance with excessively long and heavy work.

ILO (2020) *What is Child Labour?*. Available at: https://www.ilo.org/ipec/facts/lang--en/index.html (Accessed: 06 April 2020).

c. Read two more source texts below from the introduction and underline the information in the essay that the writer has taken from them.

Original source 2

The Current State of Child Labour

Below are child labour statistics and facts that might come as a surprise to you:

- More than 200 million children today are child labourers. An estimated 120 million are engaged in hazardous work.
- 73 million of these children are below 10 years old.
- The highest number of child laborers is in sub-Saharan Africa.
- The number of children in armed conflicts have risen to 300,000 over the past decade.
- Most children work on farms that produce consumer products such as cocoa, coffee, cotton, rubber and other crops.
- 20 million child workers are employed in factories that make garments, carpets, toys, matches and hand-rolled cigarettes.

The World Counts (2020) *From the Sweat of our Children.* Available at: https://www.theworldcounts.com/stories/Child-Labor-Facts-and-Statistics (Accessed: 06 April 2020).

Original Source 3

This fact sheet is about child labour in the global textile and garment supply chain, particularly in Asia. Children are being put to work at all stages of the supply chain – from the production of cotton seed, cotton harvesting and yarn spinning mills to all the phases in the cut-make-trim stage. As well as working in fields, children are also working in large formal factories and in small informal factories, as well as in sub-contracted workshops and in their own homes. Young children are working in the high-tech spinning mills, in the power loom industry, as well as weaving on hand looms. In garment factories, children perform diverse and often arduous tasks such as dyeing, sewing buttons, cutting and trimming threads, folding, moving and packing garments. In small workshops and home sites, children are put to work on intricate tasks such as embroidering, sequinning and smocking (making pleats). Children are also being put to work in sectors related to the textile and garment industry, including leather and shoes.

Thieuws, M. and Overeem, P. (2014) *Fact Sheet: Child labour in the textile & garment industry.* Available at: https://www.somo.nl/fact-sheet-child-labour-focus-on-the-role-of-buying-companies/ (Accessed: 12 April 2020).

Hybrid Working



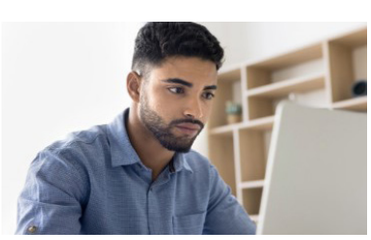
Task 1- Discussion

a. Since the COVID-19 pandemic, many companies have changed the way their staff work. Now, many employees are able to work from home a few days (or most of) a week- named 'hybrid working'. This has resulted in many different effects on the employees and the employer. Look at the effects below. For each effect, do you think the change was positive or negative?

Productivity	Mental health	Work-life balance	Company culture	Recruitment
Overhead costs	Collaboration	Communication	Staff-retention	Creativity

Analysing essay questions

Waleed is studying Business Management and has been given the following essay title for his first assignment:



> Since the COVID-19 pandemic, the working model of many companies has changed. *Describe the effects of hybrid working on the employer.*

Before Waleed starts doing any research or writing, he must know exactly what the essay question is asking him to do. He can do this by ANALYSING the essay question by looking at 4 key areas.

1. Instruction verb or words (e.g. compare, explain, discuss, evaluate- these can affect the structure and the content of the essay)
2. The main topic of the essay (what the essay is about in general)
3. The specific focus of the topic (what particular aspect you will concentrate on)
4. Limitations (anything that limits the scope of your essay e.g. time, place, type of people)

Example

Due to lack of space in many design companies, many of these businesses opt for shared offices and work areas. Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of shared offices and work areas in design companies.

a. Analyse Waleed's essay question.

Task 2- Analysing a text

Waleed has found three online texts that he would like to include as support for his ideas in his essay. When gathering information for an assignment, it is important to analyse a text appropriately. This can help you to save time and understand the ideas that are being presented.

a. Read the information below about how to analyse a text.

How to analyse a text

Step 1: Consider why you are reading it

Knowing why you are reading will affect how you read the text. Are you reading it...

- to learn about a new theory or idea?
- to find some support for an idea you already have?
- to learn something that will be discussed in a seminar?

It is important to write a list of 'research questions' that you want to find out from the text.

e.g. What are the positive effects of hybrid working for companies?
How can working from home improve productivity for employers?

Step 2: Get an overall understanding of the text

Reading everything closely straight away can be a waste of time. You may read everything and then decide the text is not helpful. Therefore, reading small parts of the text can help you to get a general more rounded idea of the text. You should...

1. Read the title- it will identify the key words of the text
2. Read the introduction (if there is one)- it should give you some context and tell you the overall structure of the text.
3. Read the first one or two sentences of each paragraph (topic sentences). They can help you understand the main idea of the paragraph and help you to identify the structure of the whole text.

Step 3: Annotate the text

Use your list of questions that you made in Step 1 to find and highlight the main points. Use one colour to highlight the main points and a different colour to highlight the supporting points and examples.

Step 4: Make notes

Take notes as you read in your own words. If you copy something exactly, remember to use ‘quotation marks’ as this can help with referencing the article later on.

Step 5: Reflect on what you have read

Before you use any of the information from the text, you need to think about what you have read. Ask yourself:

- Do you agree with all of the ideas? (you can show this in your assignment)
- What have you learnt?
- Did you find answers to your questions in Step 1?
- What will you do now with this information? (e.g. use it in your introduction, use it as support).

b. You are going to read the online text that Waleed found (Text 1) entitled 'Why Hybrid Working Models Result in More Business Growth'. Waleed has written the following research question:

Why does hybrid working result in more business growth?

Read the first paragraph, last paragraph and the first line of each of the main body paragraphs (Step 2). What is the answer to the research question?

Text 1



Why Hybrid Working Models Result in More Business Growth

by Regina Collins
2nd May 2025

In a challenging economic environment, new research has revealed that businesses operating in hybrid working models are significantly more optimistic about growth in the year ahead than those which do not offer employees flexibility about where they work. A study of more than 500 CEOs and senior business leaders by International Workplace Group (IWG) found that 69% of businesses offering hybrid working had a positive outlook for the coming year compared to 44% of non-hybrid companies (Turner, 2025). It is therefore, no wonder that most companies continue to offer hybrid models of working.

main idea

One way in which employers benefit from hybrid working is cost savings. Employers benefit from lower organisational and operational overheads. For example, companies can make savings on office rent, maintenance and utilities such as gas, electric and water (Smith, 2019). As well as this, companies have the chance to downsize as they no longer need a big space to house offices. Many businesses have got rid of permanent desks and have opted for 'hot desks' meaning that one desk is shared between a number a people depending on when they go into work.

supporting points and examples

Productivity is another way in which employers benefit. When working in a place of work, there are many distractions, interruptions and general office noise. Working remotely, however, means fewer interruptions, resulting in less stress. The comfort, convenience and flexibility of remote working allows people to be more organised and assert greater control over their schedule, giving them the opportunity to prioritise tasks and use time productively. Various research studies have revealed that productivity has increased when employees have worked remotely (Consultancy UK, 2018).

Another advantage for hybrid companies is their increased ability to retain staff. It seems that staff are happier when they have the option of working remotely. For example, staff no longer need commute to work every day, saving money on transport and time. This extra time allows for an improved work-life balance. This stress reduction and the loss of job-related anxiety make for a healthier and happier employee, improving their health and well-being (Kunsman, 2019). If a member of staff is happier, they are more likely to remain in their job.

If a company allows its employees to work remotely for a large proportion of the time, it means that the company is able to recruit from a larger pool of talent. Going into an actual place of work once a week or even once a month is now not uncommon. Therefore, the company is not restricted to recruiting people just from the geographical area of their business. Being able to access qualified candidates from a wider area has eased the burden of acquiring new talent (Hodnett, 2018). As a result, companies are better able to recruit and retain the best staff, resulting in reduced staff turnover.

Hybrid working results in cost saving, productivity, staff retention and recruitment of better talent. In effect, business growth is greater than those companies not choosing to allow hybrid working models.

Adapted from: Afghan, F. (2020). *The rise of remote working - just a fad or here for good?* Available at: https://www.simplifie.com/sales-blog/the-rise-of-remote-working-just-a-fad-or-here-for-good (Accessed: 07 May 2020).

Adapted from: Turner, L. (2025) Why Hybrid Working Models Result in More Business Growth, *Chamber of Business.* Available at: https://www.chamberofbusiness.co.uk/articles/why-hybrid-working-models-result-in-more-business-growth/ (Accessed: 15 May 2025).

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Consultancy UK (2018) *UK workers favour four-day week and increased remote working.* Available at: https://www.consultancy.uk/news/18651/uk-workers-favour-four-day-week-and-increased-remote-working (Accessed: 07 May 2020).

Hodnett, O. (2018) *Is Remote Hiring the Way to End the War for Talent?* Available at: https://hirehive.com/is-remote-hiring-the-way-to-end-the-war-for-talent/ (Accessed: 07 May 2020).

Kunsman, T. (2019) *How Remote Work Can Reduce Stress and Revitalize Your Mindset.* Available at: https://thriveglobal.com/stories/how-remote-work-can-reduce-stress-and-revitalize-your-mindset/ (Accessed: 07 May 2020).

Smith, D. (2019) *8 Ways Working from Home Saves Your Company Money.* Available at: https://www.lifesize.com/en/video-conferencing-blog/how-working-from-home-saves-your-company-money (Accessed: 07 May 2020).



c. Read the paragraphs more closely. What supporting points (examples and academic support) are provided to support the main ideas? Highlight these in the text (Step 3). The first paragraph of the main body has been done for you as an example.

d. Using the information you highlighted in Task 2c, make notes on the key points in your own words (Step 4).

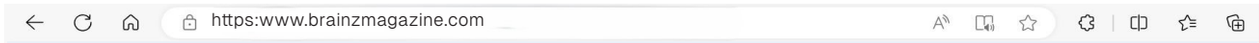
e. Reflect on the ideas in text by answering the following questions (Step 5):

1. Do you agree with all of the ideas?
2. What have you learnt?
3. Did you find answers to your questions in Step 1?
4. What could Waleed do now with this information? (e.g. use it in his introduction, use it as support).

Task 3- Analysing a text using Steps 1-5

a. Use Steps 1-5 to analyse Text 2 below.

Text 2



The Great Workplace Return –
Why Organisations Are Reducing Hybrid Working

A recent report published by CIPD highlights that 83% of organisations have a form of hybrid working in place at the moment and firms who offer hybrid working have reported that attraction and retention of talent is up 61%, plus they are able to recruit a far more diverse workforce (CIPD, 2023). However, over the last nine months I have seen more and more organisations changing the hybrid model, with many asking for people to now be in the office for 3 days a week and others looking for a full-time commitment to returning to the workplace. These requests have been met with mixed emotions.

So why are companies forcing a return to the office?

Supporters of returning to the workplace argue that physical presence fosters collaboration, innovation, and nurtures company culture. They contend that face-to-face interaction is vital for building relationships, fostering creativity, and maintaining a cohesive team dynamic. Additionally, some industries require in-person work for effective operations, such as manufacturing, healthcare, and hospitality.

Another issue that has been cited is the decrease in the talent pipeline. Some organisations have found that those people who joined during the COVID-19 pandemic lockdown (where employees had to work from home) do not have the same level of soft skills as those employees who started before the Covid-19 pandemic. An Executive Search consulting firm stated in a report in the Guardian that one problem they are seeing is graduates are unable to effectively engage with people as they don't get the same learning by 'exposure experience'. The Walt Disney Company's CEO Bob Iger said that "nothing can replace the ability to connect, observe, and create with peers that comes from being physically together". It is for this reason that The Walt Disney Company has demanded its workers to return to work on site four days a week.

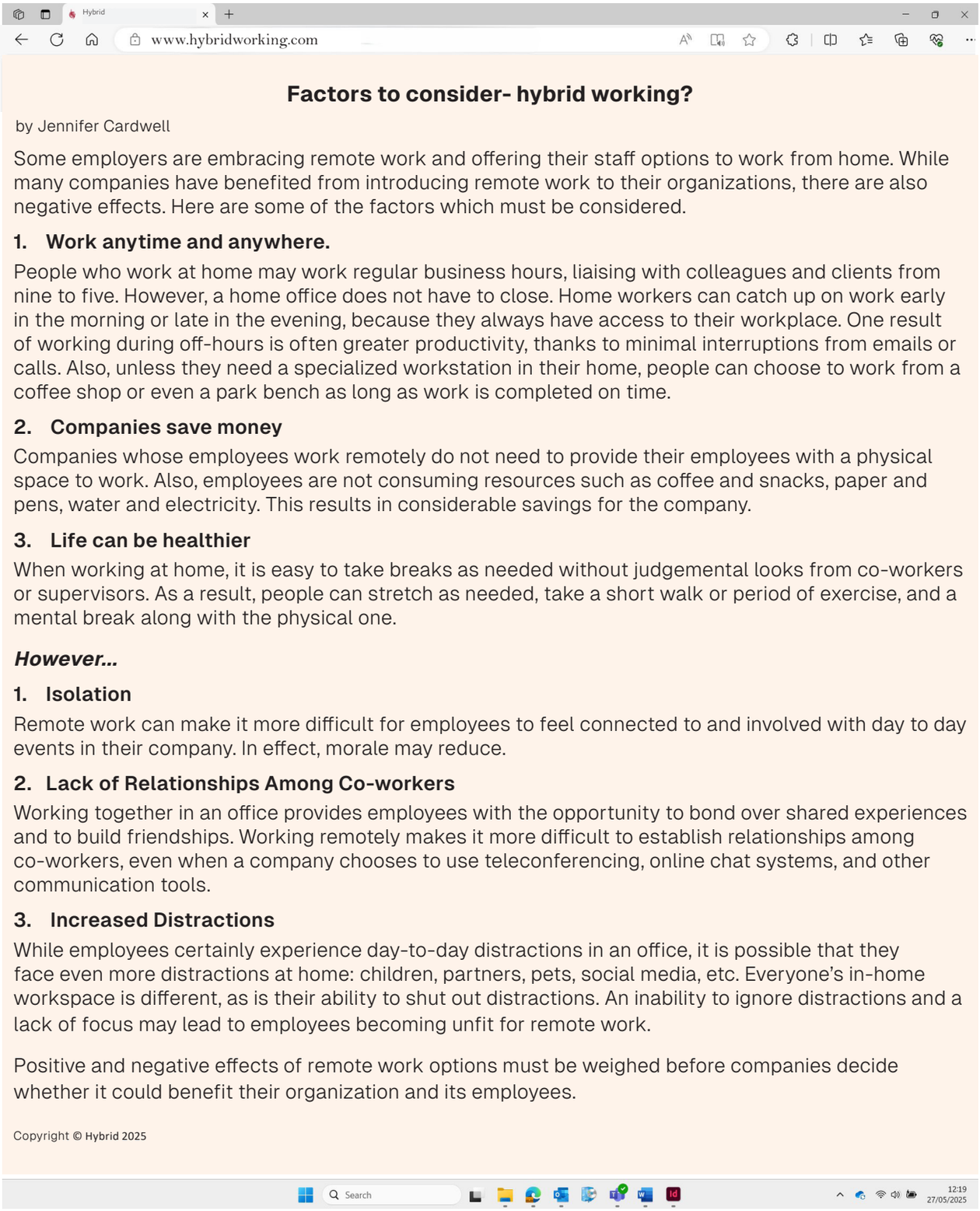
Some organisations feel that they don't have the same level of innovation using virtual meetings as they did when people were all together in one room. An example of this is Amazon who have requested a 3-day return, as they feel it encourages more "collaboration and energy" amongst their staff. Other companies have cited that they feel that remote working is having a negative effect on organisational values and culture.

Adapted from:
Jones-Williams, G (2024) 'The Great Workplace Return – Why Organisations Are Reducing Hybrid Working', *BRAINZ*, March 30th. Available at: https://www.brainzmagazine.com/post/the-great-workplace-return-why-organisations-are-reducing-hybrid-working (Accessed: 20 May 2025).

References:
CIPD (2023) *Flexible and hybrid working practices in 2023*. Available at: https://www.cipd.org/uk/knowledge/reports/flexible-hybrid-working-2023/ (Accessed: 20 May 2025).

b. Use Steps 1-5 to analyse Text 3 below.

Text 3



www.hybridworking.com

Factors to consider- hybrid working?

by Jennifer Cardwell

Some employers are embracing remote work and offering their staff options to work from home. While many companies have benefited from introducing remote work to their organizations, there are also negative effects. Here are some of the factors which must be considered.

1. Work anytime and anywhere.

People who work at home may work regular business hours, liaising with colleagues and clients from nine to five. However, a home office does not have to close. Home workers can catch up on work early in the morning or late in the evening, because they always have access to their workplace. One result of working during off-hours is often greater productivity, thanks to minimal interruptions from emails or calls. Also, unless they need a specialized workstation in their home, people can choose to work from a coffee shop or even a park bench as long as work is completed on time.

2. Companies save money

Companies whose employees work remotely do not need to provide their employees with a physical space to work. Also, employees are not consuming resources such as coffee and snacks, paper and pens, water and electricity. This results in considerable savings for the company.

3. Life can be healthier

When working at home, it is easy to take breaks as needed without judgemental looks from co-workers or supervisors. As a result, people can stretch as needed, take a short walk or period of exercise, and a mental break along with the physical one.

However...

1. Isolation

Remote work can make it more difficult for employees to feel connected to and involved with day to day events in their company. In effect, morale may reduce.

2. Lack of Relationships Among Co-workers

Working together in an office provides employees with the opportunity to bond over shared experiences and to build friendships. Working remotely makes it more difficult to establish relationships among co-workers, even when a company chooses to use teleconferencing, online chat systems, and other communication tools.

3. Increased Distractions

While employees certainly experience day-to-day distractions in an office, it is possible that they face even more distractions at home: children, partners, pets, social media, etc. Everyone's in-home workspace is different, as is their ability to shut out distractions. An inability to ignore distractions and a lack of focus may lead to employees becoming unfit for remote work.

Positive and negative effects of remote work options must be weighed before companies decide whether it could benefit their organization and its employees.

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Adapted from: John, S. (2019). *The 7 Best Reasons for Working from Home.* Available at: https://www.businessinsider.com/why-work-from-home-2019-4?r=US&IR=T (Accessed: 07 April 2020).

Adapted from: Mazzitti and Sullivan EAP (2018) *Disadvantages of Remote Work*. Available at: https://www.mseap.com/disadvantages-remote-work/ (Accessed: 07 April 2020).

Unit 3 Reduced Inequalities *(lead-in)*



10 REDUCED INEQUALITIES

"The test of our progress is not whether we add more to the abundance of those who have much; it is whether we provide enough for those who have too little". Franklin D. Roosevelt. American President.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

This unit covers:

Speaking

- Informal discussions
- Agreeing and disagreeing
- Presentation introductions
- Using notes to summarise a text

Reading

- Skimming and scanning

Writing

- Essay introductions
- Features of academic paragraphs
- Essay conclusions
- Cohesion

Grammar

- Defining relative clauses

Listening

- Listening for details in an informal conversation
- Evaluating a presentation introduction

DISCUSSION

a. Look at the following five questions, what is the meaning of the words in bold? You may use a dictionary if needed.

1. Do you think all people in your country are ***equal***?
2. Are there any members of society in your country who are viewed as less equal? If yes, who?
3. What ***stereotypes*** about people from different countries are you aware of?
4. Do you trust men or women more in a particular profession? How do you feel about male nurses? How about a female president?
5. Who do you think suffers from more ***discrimination***- young people or old people?

b. Discuss questions 1-5 in small groups.

Stereotyping



Task 1: Discussion

a. Look at the people in each picture and in small groups, answer the following questions.

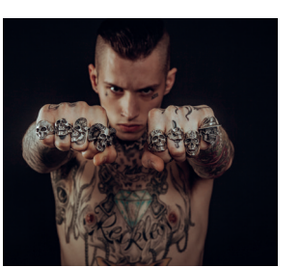
1. What nationality do you think they are?
2. What kind of personality do you think they have?
3. What job do you think they have?
4. What do you think their home-life is like?
5. How intelligent do you think they are?
6. What prejudices do you think they face in everyday life?











b. Work with a partner to discuss these questions about stereotypes.

1. What do you think of when you hear the word ‘stereotype’?
2. Are stereotypes usually accurate?
3. Do you think you stereotyped any of the people in the pictures in Task 1?
4. Where do you think stereotypes come from?
5. Do you think the media should allow stereotypes to be portrayed in TV shows/films/advertising? Why/why not?

Task 2- Presentation Introductions



As part of her course on Media and Communications, Huda needs to present a topic related to one of the key themes of her lectures. She has decided to do her presentation on '***The Causes of Stereotyping in the Mass Media and their Effects***'. She has already put together the main body of her presentation but is unsure about what information to include in her introduction. She has booked an online appointment with Emma from the Centre for English Language for some advice.

a. Listen to the conversation between Emma and Huda and complete the table with what information is **necessary** in a presentation introduction and what is **optional**.

Necessary	Optional

b. Without listening again, say whether statements (1-7) are **True**, **False** or **Not Given**.

1. Not all presentation introductions are the same in format.
2. You can spend as much time as you need introducing the topic.
3. Including a video clip can be risky.
4. You can ask the audience questions to keep their attention.
5. You should put your introduction onto a slide.
6. After giving the outline, you should say how long the presentation will last.
7. You shouldn't allow the audience to ask you questions during the presentation because it could distract you.

c. Now listen again and check your answers.

Task 3- Evaluating a presentation introduction

a. Listen to Huda delivering her introduction. Why did she choose to present this topic?

b. Listen again. Has she included all of the necessary information? Discuss your ideas in small groups.

c. Is there anything she can do to improve her introduction?

d. What do you notice about the presenter's voice? How does she use her voice to maintain the audience's attention?

Task 4- Presentation Practice

You are now going to practice giving an introduction to a presentation. The length of the whole presentation should be 5-7 minutes. Therefore, the introduction should last between 1-2 minutes.

a. Choose 1 of the following possible presentation topic titles or devise one of your own that uses the same structure.

Possible Presentation Titles

1. The effects of gender inequality.
2. The causes of wealth inequality.
3. The causes of racial inequality.

b. Plan your introduction.

c. Work in pairs or small groups. Present your introduction to each other and offer feedback. Use the following questions to guide your feedback.

1. What did your partner do well?
2. Did they include all of the key parts?
3. Did they use intonation to keep your attention?
4. Is there anything they could improve?

The Digital Divide

Task 1- Discussion

a. Look at images 1-8 below. They all show ways in which we use technology in our everyday lives. What is happening in the photos? Are these services common in your country?

1



2



3



4



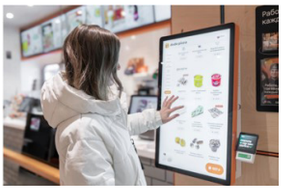
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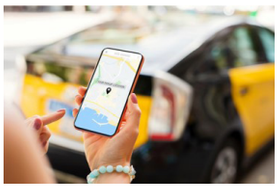
6



7



8



b. Answer the following questions in small groups:

1. How did we do the things in images 1-8 before this technology existed?
2. Why do you think these kinds of services were developed? Who do they benefit?
3. Which members of society do you think have more difficulty in using the technology in the images above?
4. What are the possible effects for the people who have difficulty using the technologies in 1-8 ? What is their alternative? How will they feel?

Task 2- Reading

a. You are going to read an article which discusses the findings of a report written by the charity *Age UK*. Read the article and answer the following questions:

According to the report:

1. What online tasks do some over 65s find difficult to do?
2. What are the social and psychological effects for some over 65s when they cannot do important online tasks?
3. To what extent does Age UK believe all older people should be able to use the Internet?

b. Discuss the findings of the report in small groups. Are you surprised by any of the information? Do you agree with all of the ideas?

More than 1 in 3 over 65s (4.7 million) lack the basic skills to use the internet successfully

New analysis by charity Age UK has found around 4.7million people aged 65 and over in the UK are unable to complete all eight of the most fundamental tasks required to use the internet successfully. These include being able to turn on devices and enter account logins, use settings and controls on a device, open applications, set up connection to wifi, open internet browsers, keep passwords secure and change passwords when prompted to do so.

And for those older people who have got over the barriers of using the internet, further analysis by Age UK shows that among those over 65s who are online, around 2.5 million are unable to complete tasks required to thrive in a digital society in day-to-day life. These key skills include being able to communicate, to store and access information and content, carry out transactions, search for information and be safe online.

In its new report, ***Offline and Overlooked***, Age UK highlights that in an increasingly digital world where almost everything from accessing NHS services and shopping to socialising and entertainment is taking place on the internet, there are millions of older people who are not online and who are being left behind. The Charity warns that it will never be possible to get everyone online and trying to force the issue poses a real risk to older people's health, finances and ability to participate in society.

Older campaigners have told the Charity that even essential tasks are becoming challenging and sometimes impossible to do. The report explores older people's struggles in managing doctor and hospital appointments, accessing council services, banking and applying for benefits.

Older people and their friends and families have also shared their feelings on the challenges they face being offline. Many of them told the Charity that they feel disempowered and left behind, just because they cannot do tasks online. They want to stay in control of how they live their lives and are fully capable of doing so, but an inability to use the internet is forcing some to rely on others, restricting their sense of agency and undermining their self-esteem.

Eutal, 76, who appears in Age UK's new campaign clip said: "I began to learn to use the internet but unexpectedly, my sight went downhill quickly. And then when I wanted to get things online, I can't. I sometimes feel really, really, embarrassed to ask somebody 'could you go online for me, and get this for me?'"

Barbara told Age UK: "It is very difficult to get a medical appointment now and my surgery is pushing more and more services online. It has got to the point where access is so difficult, I don't seek advice and just hope minor conditions just go away."

Caroline Abrahams CBE, Charity Director at Age UK said: "Older people who are not internet users or digitally savvy tell us how cross and upset they are when the main access to crucial services like doctors appointments and applications for disabled parking moves to being online. As our new report shows, this often leaves them feeling disregarded and disempowered, and the consequences can be serious, excluding them from the support they need to stay fit, well and independent.

Although many older people fully embrace the digital world, digital exclusion increases with age. Age UK believes that people should be supported and encouraged to get online, but those who cannot, or do not want to do so should be able to access services and support in a way that suits them.

Adapted from- Age UK (2024) 'More than 1 in 3 over 65s (4.7 million) lack the basic skills to use the internet successfully', *Age UK*, 2nd April. Available at: https://www.ageuk.org.uk/latest-press/articles/2024/more-than-1-in-3-over-65s-4.7-million-lack-the-basic-skills-to-use-the-internet-successfully/(Accessed: 23 September 2025).

c. Look at the underlined adjectives in the text. Match them to the meanings 1-8 below.

1. feeling uncomfortable and ashamed
2. feeling that you have no power or less likely to succeed
3. not needing to or less likely to depend on someone else
4. have a strong understanding of modern digital technology *(informal term)*
5. having power and ability
6. very important and basic
7. not given attention, respect or care
8. not included or able to progress

Task 3- Introductions

a. You are going to read two different introductions to the same essay assignment. In order to understand the assignment fully, analyse the essay question.

Essay question

While technology has enhanced the convenience of everyday life, it has highlighted the digital divide, leaving some members of society disadvantaged. Analyse one major effect of this divide with reference to one social group.

b. Read the two introductions and answer the following questions for each introduction:

1. Which social group will the essay focus on?
2. What examples are given of services that people need to be technologically literate to use?
3. Which effect of the digital divide will the essay discuss?

Introduction 1

While technology has enhanced the convenience of everyday life, it has highlighted the digital divide, leaving some members of society disadvantaged. Analyse one major effect of this divide with reference to one social group.

In the current digital age, it seems that we now require technological know-how to do simple everyday tasks. When checking-in at an airport, ordering food in a restaurant, paying for food in a supermarket, or ordering a taxi from an application, it is often no longer possible for customers to speak to an assistant in-person or over the phone. Instead, there is a need for customers to have access to the internet, use applications or navigate completely new technology such as self-service checkouts. While many tech-minded members of society find these tasks easy and convenient, some social groups who lack digital literacy are disadvantaged, leading to a digital divide between those who can, and those who cannot. This essay will firstly show that some elderly members of society are unable to use a variety of modern technologies due to digital illiteracy. It will then discuss two psychological effects of digital illiteracy: disempowerment and exclusion.

Introduction 2

While technology has enhanced the convenience of everyday life, it has highlighted the digital divide, leaving some members of society disadvantaged. Analyse one major effect of this divide with reference to one social group.

A recent study found that of 63,000+ websites, ' 88% of websites are still not fully compliant with the latest web accessibility standards' (Visser, 2024). This makes seemingly simple tasks such as booking a doctor's appointment, speaking to a customer service operator online and transferring money from an online bank more arduous for people with learning disabilities, adding to a digital divide. The UK Department of Health and Social Care (2001) defines a learning disability as 'a significantly reduced ability to understand new or complex information, to learn new skills (impaired intelligence), with a reduced ability to cope independently (impaired social functioning), which started before adulthood'. This essay will focus on people with learning disabilities. It will ascertain that the movement of crucial services from face-to-face or phone-based mediums to web-based mediums causes increased difficulty, confusion and stress for many individuals with learning disabilities.

References

DHSC (2001) 'Valuing people - a new strategy for learning disability for the 21st century'. *Department of Health and Social Care*. Available at: https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/valuing-people-a-new-strategy-for-learning-disability-for-the-21st-/e4century (Accessed: 19 September 2025).

Visser, C. (2024) 'The State of Web Accessibility in 2024 (Research Report)', *Accessibility Checker*. Available at: https://www.accessibilitychecker.org/research-papers/the-state-of-web-accessibility-in-2024-research-report/#:~:text=Out%20of%20the%2063%2C000+%20websites,barriers%20for%20people%20with%20disabilities (Accessed: 19 September 2025).

c. Read the information below about essay introductions.

Essay Introductions

Introductions are an essential part of an academic essay or report. They are usually *5-10% of the total word count* of the assignment. By the end of your introduction, the reader must understand the following points:

Essential elements

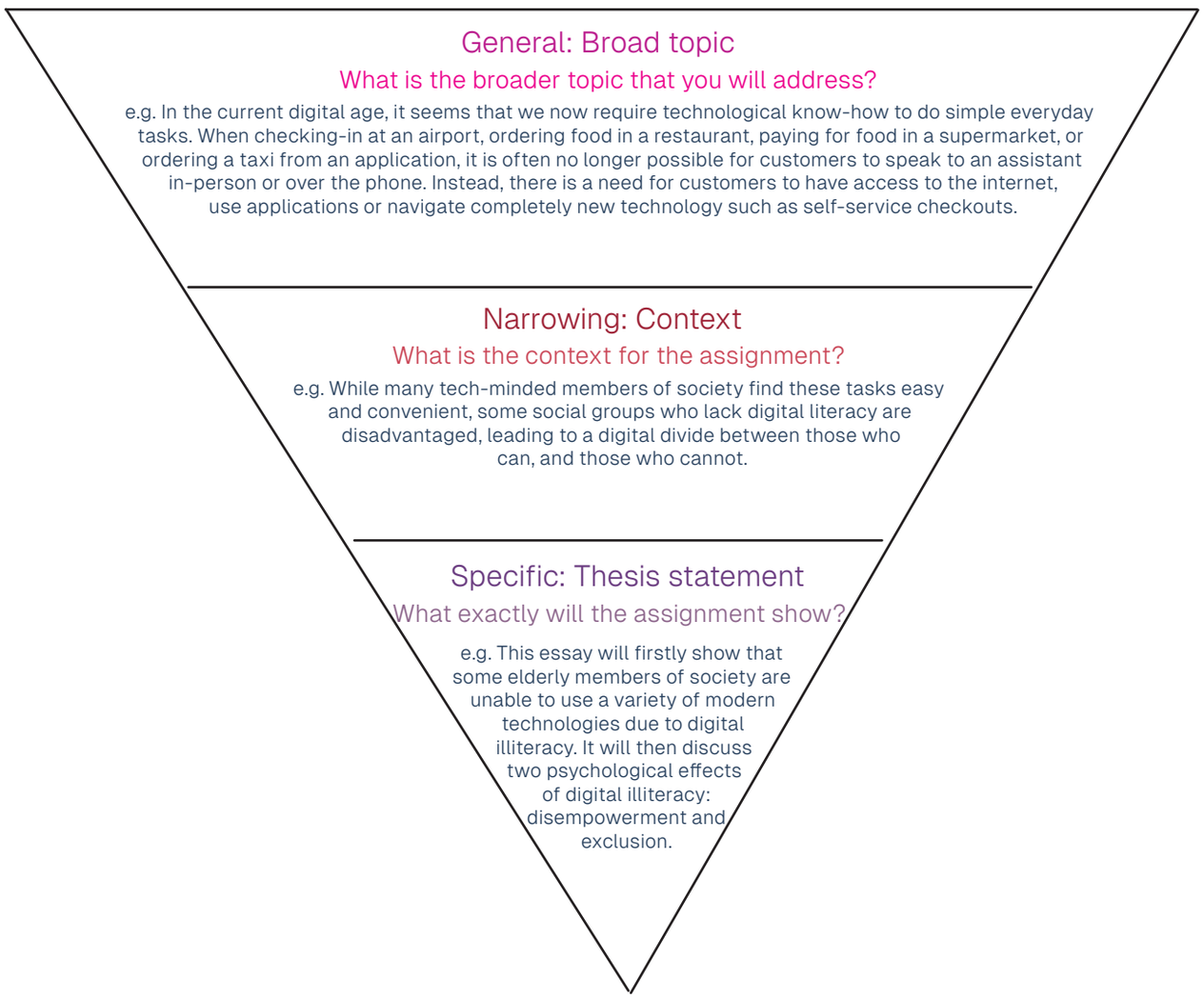
- the main topic of the essay
- the general background information of the main topic
- thesis statement (what the essay will discuss)

Optional elements

- a hook (interesting fact, opinion)
- justifications for the topic
- definitions of key terms
- outline of structure
- your opinion (if the assignment question requires it)

d. Above, you can see the features of an essay introduction. Read the two introductions again in Task 3b and identify the features used.

e. The information in an introduction usually goes from more general to specific. Look at the diagram below and the parts of introduction 1 in Task 3b that they refer too.



f. Look at Introduction 2 again in Task 3b. Identify the 'general', 'narrowing' and 'specific' information.

Task 4- Discussion

a. Discuss the following questions in small groups:

1. Are your parents digitally savvy? What about your grandparents?
2. Do you think the digital divide is a problem in your country?
3. Do you think essential services such as those relating to healthcare and banking should only be available online?

Football's Glass Ceiling



Task 1- Discussion

a. Answer the following questions in groups:

1. Do you think everyone in your country has the same opportunities to **play** professional sport or is it harder for some groups of society?
2. Do you think everyone in your country has the same opportunities to **manage** professional sports teams or it harder for some groups of society?

Task 2- Preparing to write an essay

Brijesh is studying for a Masters in Management, Law and Humanities of Sport at DMU and has been given the following essay question:

Suggest three possible reasons for the under-representation of Black professional football managers in the English Football League (EFL).

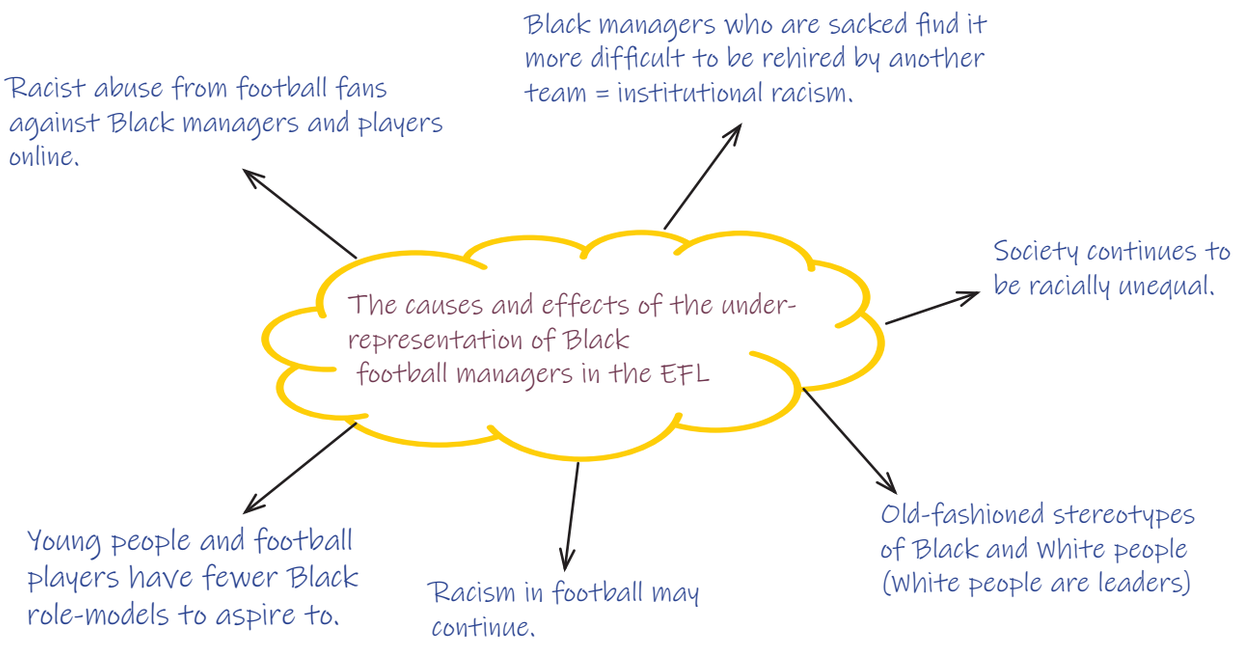


a. Answer the following questions with a partner:

1. What is the essay about?
2. What essay structure(s) could Brijesh use?
3. Why do you think there is only a small number of Black professional football managers?

b. Brijesh has understood that he needs to write a Cause-Effect essay and has brainstormed what he already knows on the essay topic. Look at his notes and decide which of his points could be used in his essay to talk about:

1. The reasons for the under-representation
2. The effects of the under-representation



c. Read the introduction to Brijesh's essay. Check your answers to the previous exercise.

Suggest three possible reasons for the under-representation of Black professional football managers in the English Football League (EFL).

In 2021, the number of Black football players in the Premier League totalled 43% (Syzmanski, 2022 cited in Kuper, 2022) showing how far racial equality has come, at least in terms of its players. Therefore, it is alarming that at the same time, the number of Black football managers totalled only 4.4% (Syzmanski, 2022 cited in Kuper, 2022). If this trend continues, society as a whole will continue to be racially unequal with fewer Black role-models for footballers and young generations to aspire to. A further effect is that racism in football could continue because Black football managers will not be seen as the norm and as a result, be discriminated against. Therefore, it is crucial that the reasons for the under-representation of Black football managers in the English Football League (EFL) are analysed. This essay will explain that institutional racism, online racist abuse from football fans and old-fashioned stereotypes are all contributing factors to the marginalisation of Black football managers in the EFL.

Kuper, S. (2022) 'English football: is it time to adopt compulsory hiring quotas for minorities?', *Financial Times*, 14 February. Available at: https://www.ft.com/content/504e7fd8-7d60-4250-8ee3-2778e59d6f08 (Accessed: 16 February 2022).

d. Read the introduction to the essay again and answer the following questions:

1. What essay structure will Brijesh use, '*Focus on Causes*' or '*Focus on Effects*'?
2. Where is the *thesis statement*? Does it show Brijesh's opinion?

Task 3- Features of academic paragraphs

a. Read about the three main elements of cohesive academic paragraphs and the key advice.

The 3 main elements of cohesive academic paragraphs

1. The topic sentence:

- Introduces the main idea of the paragraph
- Relates to the essay question
- Relates to the thesis statement
- Often found in the first sentence of a paragraph

2. The supporting sentences

- Develop the idea in the topic sentence
- Can contain details such as reasons, explanations, effects, examples, definitions, opinions, statistics and academic support
- Should contain academic support which supports the main idea in the topic sentence

3. The concluding sentence

- Is optional. They are useful when writing very long paragraphs and/or in longer pieces of work.
- Can summarise the content of the paragraph
- Can link the paragraph to the next paragraph
- Can provide a deduction, such as an opinion

Key Advice

- An academic paragraph should contain only one main idea.
- Your idea should be explained, developed and supported with evidence.
- Your evidence should be from an academic source.
- Your paragraph should contain mostly ideas from yourself, not from sources.

b. Read the following paragraph from Brijesh's essay. Identify any of the following:

examples *a topic sentence* *concluding sentence* *academic support*
explanations *reasons* *definitions* *opinions* *statistics*

One possible reason for the under-representation of Black football managers is due to Black football managers not receiving the same opportunities as their White counterparts, which could be classed as Institutional Racism. It can be seen that when a football team in the EFL underperforms, White managers who are sacked, are often hired again as managers at another football club in the EFL. However, Black managers do not seem to be given the same prospects. Two cases in point are that of Chris Ramsey and Jean Tigana who were sacked from their manager positions and then were never hired again in managing positions in the EFL. According to Chris Ramsey, it is difficult for any football manager to find work but it is harder as a black man (Stone, 2015). This unfair treatment by football boards and Executives could be a significant reason for the under-representation of Black football managers.

Stone, S. (2015) 'Is football failing black managers? BBC Sport investigates', *BBC*, Available at: https://www.bbc.co.uk/sport/football/31970841 (Accessed: 17 February 2022).

c. Read sentences a-f from the second paragraph of Brijesh's essay. Put the sentences in order to form a cohesive paragraph.

a. While racist chants can still occur during a football match, unlike in the past, racist comments now occur online too.

b. Research has shown that during the 2014/15 season, there were '95,000 discriminatory social media posts directed at EPL [English Premier League] teams, with approximately 39,000 such posts aimed at EPL players' (Bennet and Jonsson, 2017 cited in Kilvington and Price, 2019, p. 65).

c. Social media platforms such as Facebook and Twitter are used by football fans to racially abuse football players and managers.

d. It is clear that social media companies need to do more to control abusive behaviour on their platforms.

e. One such incident towards Chris Hughton (Norwich City's former manager) and was so particularly bad that it was reported to the police as a 'hate crime'.

f. A further factor which could hinder potential Black people from entering the football managing profession is the online racist abuse they may receive from football fans.

Kilvington, D. and Price, J. (2019) 'Tackling Social Media Abuse? Critically Assessing English Football's Response to Online Racism', *Communication and Sport,* 7(1) pp. 64-79.

Task 4- Cohesion in essays

a. Look at the essay question, thesis statement and the two topic sentences from Brijesh's main body paragraphs. Notice how the ideas and language all relate to one another.

Essay Question	Suggest three possible reasons for the under-representation of Black professional football managers in the English Football League (EFL).
Thesis Statement	This essay will explain that institutional racism, online racist abuse from football fans and old-fashioned stereotypes are all contributing factors to the marginalisation of Black football managers in the EFL.
Topic Sentence 1	One possible reason for the under-representation of Black football managers is due to Black football managers not receiving the same opportunities as their White counterparts, which could be classed as Institutional Racism.
Topic Sentence 2	A further factor which could hinder potential Black people from entering the football managing profession is the online racist abuse they may receive from football fans.

b. Write a suitable topic sentence for the third paragraph of Brijesh's essay.

.....

.....

Throughout Britain's history, White middle-class men have been perceived as 'leaders' and even today in politics, business and education, White men are more prevalent. Although when choosing a new manager, boards do not seem to consciously discriminate, these deep- rooted stereotypes could influence their decision making. Research by Gundemir *et al.* (2014) demonstrates that bias of pro-White leadership accounts for the marginalisation of ethnic minorities in leadership positions. .....

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Gundemir, S. *et al.* (2014) 'Think Leader, Think White? Capturing and Weakening an Implicit Pro-White Leadership Bias', *PLoS One*, 9(1). doi: 10.1371/journal.pone.0083915

c. Underline the concluding sentences in the two main body paragraphs. What is the purpose of each one?

d. Write a concluding sentence to the third main body paragraph.

Task 5- Reacting to the topic

a. Discuss the following questions in small groups. Make sure you give reasons and details and that each person shares their opinion. One member of the group should take notes on the ideas discussed.

1. Do you agree that under-representation of races in management is a problem?
2. Do you think there should be a law that sports clubs should have to have a certain number of managers from minority ethnic groups?
3. Do you think people who make racist comments on social media should be punished? If yes, how?
4. Do you think we will ever live in an equal society?

Useful Language: Agreeing and Disagreeing

Agreeing

I agree with you.

Yes, I think so too.

Yes, I'm with you on that.

I couldn't agree more.

Yes, you're absolutely right.

That's what I think.

That's a good point.

Partly Agreeing

Yes, OK, but...

I see what you mean but...

I take your point but...

That may be true, but...

Disagreeing

Sorry, I can't agree with you on that because...

I don't think that's right/true.

I don't see how you can say...

But you can't really mean...?

b. Use your group's notes to share your answers with the class. Listen to each group: do you agree with their points of view?

Seeking Sanctuary



Task 1- Discussion

a. Discuss the following questions in small groups:

1. What is the difference between a ***refugee*** and an ***asylum seeker***?
2. Why do you think refugees and asylum seekers leave their countries?
3. Does your country host many refugees and asylum seekers? If yes, where in the world are they typically from?
4. What hardships do you think refugees and asylum seekers face when living in a new country?

b. Read the following facts, do any of them shock you?

1. '86% of the world's refugees are hosted by developing countries' (MRSN, 2020).
2. In the UK, asylum seekers are banned from working. They must self-finance or survive on £5.66 per day (Refugee Action, 2022).
3. 'When a person is given refugee status, they have just 28 days to find accommodation and apply for mainstream benefits before they are evicted from asylum accommodation. Many refugees become homeless at this stage' (MRSN, 2020).
4. 'Research suggests that asylum seekers are five times more likely to have mental health needs than the general population and more than 61% will experience serious mental distress. However, data shows that they are less likely to receive support than the general population' (Mental Health Foundation, 2022).

Mental Health Foundation (2022) *Mental health statistics: refugees and asylum seekers.* Available at: https://www.mentalhealth.org.uk/statistics/mental-health-statistics-refugees-and-asylum-seekers (Accessed: 21 February 2022).

MRSN (2020) *Facts about Refugees.* Available at: https://mrsn.org.uk/facts-about-refugees/ (Accessed: 21 February 2022).

Refugee Action (2022) *Facts about Refugees.* Available at: https://www.refugee-action.org.uk/about/facts-about-refugees/ (Accessed: 21 February 2022).

c. Compare your reactions in groups.

Task 2- Cohesion in an essay

a. Read the assignment question and its introduction then answer the questions that follow.

Explain how one initiative in your city helps asylum seekers and refugees to improve their mental health and well-being.

While there are many obvious problems for asylum seekers and refugees upon their arrival in the UK such as finding adequate accommodation, food, and money, their mental health and well-being may also suffer. Many asylum seekers and refugees may have seen atrocities in their countries, may be uncertain about their future and can face culture shock. Therefore, it is important that not only are their life's essentials taken care of, but problems with their mental health and well-being are addressed too. This essay will explain how the 'Football Welcomes Community Project' in the city of Leicester benefits refugees and asylum seekers by improving their mental health and well-being.

1. How do you think the 'Football Welcomes Community Project' aids mental health and well-being?
2. Underline the thesis statement. What do you think the main body will talk about?
3. Is it a successful introduction?

b. Read the topic sentences of each main body paragraph. Which one is not needed? Why?

1. The Football Welcomes Community Project is one programme that can help to improve asylum seekers' and refugees' mental health. 'Leicester City of Sanctuary' and 'After 18', two charities, host the event with partnership from Leicester City Football Club.
2. One way in which the programme helps asylum seekers and refugees is that it simply allows them to have fun.
3. A further advantage of the Football Welcomes Community Project is that it provides refugees and asylum seekers with a regular time and space to exercise, which is extremely beneficial for their health.
4. An additional benefit of the project is that the refugees and asylum seekers are brought together with members of the host community.
5. Finally, it is important to discuss the drawbacks of this initiative.

c. Improve the introduction by writing a sentence(s) to show the main themes of the essay.

d. Read the conclusion to the essay. Identify the sentence(s) which relate to the essay question, thesis statement and topic sentences.

It is clear from this essay that the Football Welcomes Community Project is a very successful initiative that welcomes refugees and asylum seekers from countries all around the world. While many of these people arrive in Leicester with problems that affect their mental health and well-being, the initiative goes some way to improve this. It has been shown that the Football Welcomes Community Project provides fun and enjoyment whilst providing an opportunity to do exercise. In addition, integrating with existing members of the community allows refugees and asylum seekers to feel welcomed and accepted into their new community. It is believed that maintaining an active lifestyle can help with mental well-being, especially those which encourage social interaction. Therefore, it is suggested that the government should finance more sports clubs and charities to provide refugees and asylum seekers with more free sports activities.

Task 3- Conclusions

a. Read the information about conclusions and complete gaps 1-14 with a suitable word/phrases from the orange box. There are some options that you do not need.

future research *main ideas* *new supporting points* *should* *deductions* *20%* *10%* *must* *predictions* *assignment question* *assignment question* *must not* *should not* *topic sentences* *could* *evidence* *thesis statement* *limitations*

- A conclusion to an essay or report is usually around [1] ..... of the total word count.
- It should summarise the [2] ..... of the essay and should relate to the [3] ..... , the [4] ..... and the [5] ..... .
- It should not contain [6] ..... or [7] ..... .
- It is important to note that a conclusion is not just a summary, it should also make [8] ..... based on the evidence and ideas in the essay.
- A conclusion [9] ..... include extra comments such as recommendations, [10] ..... or final opinions of the writer.
- Suggestions for [11] ..... and [12] ..... of the research are common in conclusions of longer essays and reports.
- Most importantly, a conclusion [13] ..... show that you have answered the [14] ..... .

b. Read two alternative conclusions to the essay and for each one, answer the following questions:

1. Does it contain a summary of the main points of the essay?
2. Does it make deductions?
3. Does it contain comments such as predictions and suggestions?
4. Does it contain any new supporting points related to the essay question?
5. Does it answer the essay question?
6. Is the conclusion successful?

Conclusion 1

In conclusion, football brings together people of all ages and nationalities and the Football Welcomes Community Project is no different. It goes above and beyond to help refugees and asylum seekers with their mental health and well-being. There are many benefits of participating in this programme as it provides an opportunity to forget about day-to-day problems and allows the participants to have fun. A further advantage is that the programme also provides the opportunity for the participants to practise their English with each other in a relaxed environment; thus, well-being is improved as they can develop confidence in their speaking ability. Even though extra funding would be required, it is suggested that the initiative should run at multiple times during the week to allow even more people to take part in this worthy initiative.

Conclusion 2

Refugees and asylum seekers often arrive in the UK with problems that can affect their mental health and well-being. For example, they may be homesick, have culture shock or even Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder. Therefore, it is important that the UK government and charities provide initiatives such as the Football Welcomes Community Project for these people which can help to alleviate their problems.



Task 4- Discussion

a. Discuss the following questions in small groups. Make sure you provide reasons and details and use language for opinions, agreeing and disagreeing.

1. Do you think rich nations should take more responsibility in welcoming more refugees and asylum seekers to their country?
2. In the UK, asylum seekers are not allowed to work. Why do you think this is? Is this a good idea?
3. What benefits are there for a country which takes in refugees and asylum seekers?
4. What disadvantages are there for a country which takes in refugees and asylum seekers?
5. If you ever needed to seek refuge in another country, which country do you think you would want to go to?

b. Share your ideas with the class.

c. Choose two of the questions from Task 4a and write a paragraph for each giving your opinions. Remember to structure it accordingly.







Unit 4 Quality Education *(lead-in)*





"Education breeds confidence. Confidence brings hope. Hope breeds peace". Confusious, Chinese Philosopher.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

This unit covers:

Speaking

- Reflecting
- Using signposting phrases in presentations
- Seminar discussions

Reading

- Reading for details
- Skimming for gist

Writing

- Reporting verbs
- In-text referencing structures
- Paraphrasing

Listening

- Lecture organisation
- Note-taking structures
- Note-taking practice
- Using symbols and abbreviations
- Comprehension in a mini-lecture

Grammar

- Articles

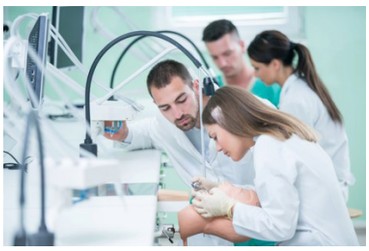
DISCUSSION

1. According to UK Parliament (2025), the number of international students in the UK accounts for 23% of the total student population. What are the reasons that so many students from around the world choose to study in the UK? Brainstorm your ideas in small groups.

2. In your groups decide which three of your reasons for studying at a UK university are the most important.

Reference
UK Parliament (2025) *International students in UK higher education.* Available at: https://commonslibrary.parliament.uk/research-briefings/cbp-7976/. Accessed: 10 October 2025.

Learning Preferences



Task 1- Discussion

a. Go online and search for the VAK learning styles model. This is a very popular theory about how we learn. What can you find out?

b. Read Adam's experiences of training to be a teacher.



"When I was training to be a teacher, we had a lecture about the ***VAK*** learning styles model. According to the lecturer, some students like to learn by seeing. These are ***visual*** learners. Some prefer to learn by listening; we call them ***auditory*** learners. Then there are others who prefer to learn by moving around and doing things – the ***kinaesthetic*** learners ".

c. Below you can see a list of activities (1-9). Which activities might the three different kinds of learners prefer? Match an activity with a *visual*, *auditory* or *kinaesthetic* learner. You can choose more than one learner for each activity. The first activity has been done for you as an example.

1. Watching a video visual, auditory
2. Practising a skill hands-on (e.g., experiment)
3. Drawing a map
4. Participating in a group discussion
5. Building a model
6. Reading a diagram or chart
7. Following verbal instructions
8. Acting out a role-play
9. Listening to a podcast

d. Compare your answers with a partner. Do you agree?

e. Do you think you have a preferred way of learning? Discuss your ideas in groups.

f. Read about Adam's experience after his lecture.



'So, according to the theory we learned, people are Visual, Auditory or Kinaesthetic learners – VAK is the abbreviation for this. However, in the weeks after my lecture, in my independent reading, I found that the VAK theory of learning styles has been widely criticised.'

g. Discuss the following questions in small groups:

1. Can physical movement help someone to learn a language? What else would you need? Teachers can give commands to children such as "Stand up", "Turn around", "Sit down". The children can do the actions to memorise the words.
2. Can listening to a lecture about art help you to become good at drawing? What else would help you?
3. Can you improve the way you play the piano just by reading about it? What other input would you need?
4. Can looking at photos of players help you to be good at tennis or basketball? Why or why not?
5. Considering your ideas in questions 1-4, why do you think the VAK theory of learning styles has been criticised?

Task 2- Reading

a. After teaching for a few years, Adam wrote an article for a teacher's magazine called '*How to help your students learn*'. Read the article and choose a heading for each paragraph from the list below (1-7). There is one that you do not need to use.

Paragraph Headings

1. Learning by Action
2. Rethinking Learning Styles
3. Listening Paired with Expression
4. From Style Myths to Flexible Practice
5. Visual Pathways to Understanding
6. Learning and long-term memory
7. Learning Preferences Are More Useful

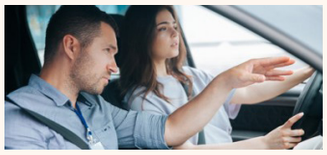
Glossary:

- ***Modality*** is a formal and scientific word for 'a way of doing or experiencing something'. The three VAK styles of learning are ***modalities***.
- ***Comprehension*** is a synonym for understanding.
- ***Dense text*** is a text that gives a lot of information in a few words.

How to help your students learn



Graphs can often explain information more clearly than words (Biggs and Tang, 2011).



As stated by Bazán-Perkins and Santibañez-Salgado (2025) doing a task completes the learning process.



Teachers need to present material through varied modalities (Newton and Miah, 2017; Bazán-Perkins & Santibañez-Salgado, 2025).

1.
Many people assume that each of us has one ideal way to learn- by seeing, hearing, or doing. However, this idea has been questioned by recent research. As Rogowsky *et al.* (2020) conclude, 'providing instruction based on students' learning style preferences does not improve learning.' While learners might prefer one modality, that preference does not guarantee better learning (Newton and Miah, 2017; Bazán-Perkins and Santibañez-Salgado, 2025).

2.
Rather than insisting on fixed styles, it is more helpful to think of preferences or modalities. Students can benefit by varying their study approaches. For instance, if reading the same paragraph several times does not lead to understanding, changing to diagrams or group discussion may help (Rogowsky *et al.*, 2020). According to Hattie and O'Leary (2025), combining modalities often produces stronger memory and comprehension. Relying on just one preferred method may prevent students from experimenting with new ways of understanding (Newton and Miah, 2017).

3.
Visual tools-graphs, charts, maps, diagrams- present information in forms distinct from text. Biggs and Tang (2011) state that a curve on a graph can help to make growth patterns easier to understand than reading a written description. In the same way, maps can show how war zones move from place to place over time more clearly than text alone. For learners who have difficulty with dense text, these visual aids can offer an alternative way to understand the information.

4.
Listening alone is rarely enough for deep retention. Combining listening with note-taking, paraphrasing, or discussion increases recall (Rogowsky *et al.*, 2020). Students who prefer the auditory modality often also benefit from speaking, summarising aloud, or teaching concepts to someone else. This way students are not just receiving information, they are taking an active part in learning (Newton and Miah, 2017).

5.
Some students prefer active learning, also called kinaesthetic learning, which means learning through doing. For example, it is easier to learn to fix a bicycle by practising than simply by watching a video. In cases like this, background support (instruction, explanation, demonstration) is part of the process, but the important thing is carrying out the action itself. Bazán-Perkins and Santibañez-Salgado (2025) found that tasks such as driving or laboratory experiments show how doing completes the learning process.

6.
A large amount of evidence now suggests that strict learning styles do not really exist (Rogowsky *et al.*, 2020; Hattie and O'Leary, 2025). However, preferences do exist and students should be encouraged to experiment with multiple modalities rather than staying with just one. For teachers, presenting material through varied modalities increases the chances that ideas will be easier for many learners to understand (Newton and Miah, 2017; Bazán-Perkins and Santibañez-Salgado, 2025).

References

Bazán-Perkins, B. and Santibañez-Salgado, J. A. (2025) Relationship between the learning gains and learning style preferences among students from the school of medicine and health sciences. *BMC Medical Education*, 25(71) Available at: https://doi.org/10.1186/s12909-024-06554-0

Biggs, J. and Tang, C. (2011) *Teaching for quality learning at university* (4th ed.). Open University Press.

Hattie, J. and O'Leary, T. (2025) Learning Styles, Preferences, or Strategies? An explanation for the resurgence of styles across many meta-analyses, *Educational Psychology Review,* 37(31) Available at: https://doi.org/10.1007/s10648-025-10002-w

Newton, P. M. and Miah, M. (2017) Evidence-based higher education – Is the learning styles 'myth' important? *Frontiers in Psychology*, 8, Available at: DOI: 10.3389/fpsyg.2017.00444

Rogowsky, B. A. *et al.* (2020). Providing instruction based on students' learning style preferences does not improve learning. *Frontiers in Psychology.* Available at: doi: 10.3389/fpsyg.2020.00164

Task 3- In-text referencing structures

a. Read the information in the box below about in-text referencing structures.

In-text Referencing Structures

When paraphrasing, summarising or quoting someone else's work in your writing, you must include a reference to the original source. You can do this in two ways:

1. Use a Non-Integral Reference (Idea-led)

The surname of the author and year the information was published comes in brackets at the end of the citation.

e.g. Relying on just one preferred method may prevent students from experimenting with new ways of understanding (Newton and Miah, 2017).

2. Use an Integral Reference (Author-led)

Introduce the surname of the author and the date (in brackets) followed by a reporting verb at the beginning of the sentence.

e.g. Biggs and Tang (2011) state that a curve on a graph can help to make growth patterns easier to understand than reading a written description.

b. Look back at Adam's article and answer the following questions:

1. How many sources did Adam use?
2. How many times did Adam use each source?
3. Underline the non-integral reference(s).
4. Circle the integral reference(s).
5. Which reporting verbs/structures are used? What is the meaning of these verbs/ structures?

Grammar of Reporting Verbs

1. Reporting verbs can have the following grammar pattern:

Subject + verb + that + subject + verb [+ object / complement]

- Biggs and Tang (2011) state that a curve on a graph can help to make growth patterns easier to understand than reading a written description.

2. Not all reporting verbs follow this pattern. 'Present', 'support' and 'describe' are followed by a noun or noun phrase:

Subject + verb + noun phrase

- The pie chart presents the number of students who attended the lecture,
- Elcome (2016) describes the reaction of students to his new teaching methods.

3. To 'show' can follow both patterns:

Verb + noun phrase/ verb + that clause (that + a subject + a verb)

- The pie chart shows the number of students who believe they are auditory learners.
- The pie chart shows that auditory learners account for more than 50% of the total number of students.

4. 'According to X' means 'in the opinion of X' and follows this pattern:

According to + subject + comma + clause (a subject + a verb)

- According to Hattie and O'Leary (2025), combining modalities often produces stronger memory and comprehension.

c. Read sentences 1-6. There are problems with the grammar and punctuation used with the reporting verb. Correct the grammar in the sentences.

1. The pie chart shows that the number of students who prefer to learn kinaesthetically.
2. According to Karim (2024) that the number of students who do not know how they learn is significant.
3. The chart shows that the rise in student attainment.
4. Jackson (2025) supports that the use of the VAK modalities.
5. According to (2023), Taylor states that it is imperative to take notes when listening to a lecture.
6. Yusuf (2018) describes that her class's negative reaction to learning through just one modality.

Task 4- Choosing reporting verbs

a. The reporting verb you use can show the attitude of the writer. Reporting verbs show three feelings. Read the examples below:

Being tentative

The writer does not want to sound too sure.

- Taylor (2014) ***suggests*** that…
- Noseley (2017) ***speculates*** that…
- Hind (2013) ***proposes*** that…

Being forceful

The writer is expressing a strong view.

- Bower (2019) ***argues*** that…
- Oldham (2017) ***contends*** that…
- Kali (2012) ***maintains*** that…

Being neutral

The writer is referring to facts that s/he wants the reader to know.

- Blow (1999) ***points out*** that…
- Timms (2025) ***describes how…***
- ***According to*** Mavridi (2016), …
- Sansom and Slack (2008) ***state*** that…
- Rule *et al.* (2024) ***concludes that…***

b. Read citations 1-8 and decide from the choice of words if the researcher referred to is being *tentative*, *neutral* or *forceful*. Underline language that suggest the writer's attitude and choose a suitable reporting verb. There is more than one possibility for each answer. The first one has been done as an example.

1. Tutla (2018) ..... suggests that ..... although the evidence is <u>inconclusive</u>, doing sports after class <u>may</u> be contributing to students' achievement of better grades.
2. Moyo (2025) ..... there is <u>absolutely no evidence</u> that learning online is contributing to students' achievement of better grades.
3. ..... Oldham (2024), often students do not know how they learn best.
4. After reviewing the available evidence, Bragoli (2020) .....students' achievement of better grades may be due to factors that are still unknown.
5. Hassan (2022) ..... in 2017, a group of students who were taught using a range of teaching methods scored better on tests than a control group that used just one teaching method.
6. Rule (2018) ..... the use of non-traditional teaching methods in class has been shown to have beneficial effects as well as negative ones.
7. Although her position has been strongly criticised, Pyrah (2024) ..... lecturers must not continually use the same teaching methods as students can get bored more easily.
8. Yusuf (2021) ..... 'students whose teachers adapt their lessons to suit their students' learning styles achieve better grades. However, Kali (2022) ..... Yusuf may possibly be overstating her case.

Task 5- Using in-text references

a. You are going to write some citations with a reporting verb and reference. The citation you write will depend on the answers you receive from your classmates. Ask some classmates the following questions. Make sure you take notes and that you know the family names of all the people you talk to.

1. How did you react to your first lesson at DMU? [Give a description]
2. How do you think you learn best? [Possibly… maybe…]
3. In what way are mobile phones useful for class work? [make some suggestions]
4. Should teachers confiscate mobile phones? Why, or why not? [What's your argument?]
5. How long should students have for lunch? [Give your opinion]

b. Write up the answers you have collected as citations with an in-text reference.

e.g. Alshammari (2026) speculates that...
Zhang (2026) suggests that...
According to Li (2026)...

Hybrid Learning



Task 1

a. Look at the pictures of different learning environments and answer the questions that follow.

Traditional Learning



Online Learning



Hybrid Learning



1. What are the benefits of learning in each environment?
2. What are the disadvantages of learning in each environment?
3. If you had a lecture to attend, which learning environment would you prefer?
4. If you had a seminar to attend, which learning environment would you prefer?

b. Compare your answers with a partner making sure you explain your reasons.

Task 2- Note-taking from a seminar talk

a. Student Services is delivering a seminar to new undergraduate students. In this seminar, Chris Jackson gives a short talk on the learning environments students can expect on their courses. Listen to the introduction and answer the following questions:

1. Which learning environment will be used on the students' courses?
2. Why has the university decided to use this type of learning environment?
3. What is Chris going to do in the seminar?
4. What are the students going to do in the seminar?

b. Now listen to Chris giving the main part of her talk and make notes below on the key points she mentions.

Benefits of Hybrid Learning	Challenges of Hybrid Learning

c. Discuss the following questions in groups.

1. Do you think Hybrid Learning is a good idea? Why/Why not?
2. Have your opinions on Hybrid Learning changed since listening to Chris?
3. Learning online effectively can be challenging for some people. What can you do to ensure successful learning online? Write five pieces of advice in the box below.

Ensuring successful learning online- 5 tips

i.

ii.

iii.

iv.

v.

Task 3- Paraphrasing

a. The students' task in the seminar is to deliver a short presentation which gives advice on how to learn online effectively. Look at the PowerPoint slide below from one seminar group's presentation. Why do you think the group decided to include academic support?

Tip 1

Remove all digital distractions such as mobile phones and smart watches from your study area.

→ "Multi-tasking can cause errors, confusion and waste time, decreasing performance and the ability to learn" (EBSCOpost, 2022).

EBSCOpost (2022) *Create Productive and Happy E-learners – Train Them to Reduce Distractions.* Available at: https://www.ebsco.com/blogs/ebscopost/create-productive-and-happy-e-learners-train-them-reduce-distractions (Accessed: 09 May 2022).

b. Now look at the second tip from the group's presentation. Why do you think they used a paraphrase instead of a direct quote?

Tip 2

Make sure your study environment is tidy.

→ Futurelearn (2022) states that if you have mess all around you, it can lead to a lack of focus and feeling disorganised.

Futurelearn (2022*) How to succeed with online learning.*Available at: https://www.futurelearn.com/info/blog/how-to-succeed-with-online-learning (Accessed: 09 May 2022).

c. Read the original extract from which the academic support in Tip 2 was taken. Which sentence(s) were used? Do you think the students paraphrased successfully?

Keep it neat and tidy

There are several studies that link a cluttered environment with a difficulty to focus. The reasoning is that, when there are lots of different objects for your brain to take in, it can't process situations as fast. This reasoning is also why we can feel unfocused and scatter-brained when we're surrounded by clutter.

Futurelearn (2022) *How to succeed with online learning.* Available at: https://www.futurelearn.com/info/blog/how-to-succeed-with-online-learning (Accessed: 09 May 2022).

d. What features do you think a successful paraphrase contains? Make a list.

e. Read the following information about paraphrasing. Match paragraph headings a-e with paragraphs 1-5.

Paragraph Headings 1-5

a. How can I paraphrase successfully?
b. What should I paraphrase?
c. What are the dangers of paraphrasing?
d. Why should I use a paraphrase rather than a direct quote?
e. What is paraphrasing?

Paraphrasing: an important skill

1. .....

Paraphrasing is a useful skill which can help you to avoid plagiarism. It is used when you want to include information from an academic source in order to support your point in an assignment. However, you cannot simply copy the information from the original source. You must change the language, the sentence grammar and the structure and keep the meaning the same. This means that paraphrasing is not always easy or quick to do, but it is a crucial skill to master.

2. .....

Using paraphrases show your teacher, lecturer and readers that you have fully understood the topic you are writing about. It is easier to include direct quotes throughout your assignment, but these can show laziness and a lack of analysis.

3. .....

When you want to include a citation in your assignment to give academic support, it is a good idea to paraphrase single sentences or short extracts of information from academic sources. This is because there is less risk of plagiarism. If you paraphrase long extracts of information, there are more vocabulary and grammar structures to deal with, so the meaning of the sentences are at more risk of changing or for plagiarism to occur. Using shorter extracts also ensures that most of the paragraph you are writing is information from yourself- don't allow citations to dominate your paragraph, you will not achieve high marks.

4. .....

Some students try to paraphrase quickly by just rewriting the extract off the top of their heads. However, this could lead to poor academic practice because the grammar and vocabulary used may not have been changed thoroughly. Also remember, every time you include a paraphrase in a citation, you must include an in-text reference.

5. .....

Paraphrasing is not a simple skill to learn overnight. It takes practice. Here are some features to look out for which can help you decide if your paraphrase is suitable:

1: Specialist terms should be kept the same and not changed.
2: Words that can be changed, i.e. words that can be replaced with a synonym or a phrase, must be changed.
3. The synonyms used should use an alternative word form to the original e.g. change verbs from active to passive, verbs to nouns and vice versa.
4: The structure of the whole paraphrase should be different to the original (if logical).
5: The paraphrase must have exactly the same meaning as the original, with no new information added.
6: An in-text reference should be used to acknowledge your original source.

f. By using the information (not reading word for word), answer the questions from the paragraphs headings.

g. Which of your ideas from Task 3d does the text mention? Add any other features of a successful paraphrase to your list.

Task 4- Recognising a suitable paraphrase

a. The students have made three attempts to write a suitable paraphrase on the next slide of their presentation. Look at their three attempts and for each attempt, compare the group's paraphrase with the original source and decide if the paraphrase is suitable and say why/why not in 'your comments'.

Original source

Online chat boosts interactivity and reduces isolation while learning online (Heaslip *et al.* 2013, cited in Huang, 2022).

Heaslip, G. *et al.* (2013, cited in Huang, Q. 2022) 'Does learning happen? A mixed study of online chat data as an indicator of student participation in an online English course', *Education and Information Technologies.* Available at: https://doi.org/10.1007/s10639-022-10963-3.

Slide attempt 1

Tip 3

Engage in the lesson: Use the chat facility to like, leave and reply to other students' comments.

.

Using the online chat feature increases interaction and decreases feelings of loneliness when taking part in online learning (Heaslip *et al.* 2013, cited in Huang, 2022).

Your comments:

Slide attempt 2

Tip 3

Engage in the lesson: Use the chat facility to like, leave and reply to other students' comments.

While learning online, chatting online can boost interactivity and decrease isolation (Heaslip *et al.*, 2013, cited in Huang, 2022).

Your comments:

Slide attempt 3

Tip 3

Engage in the lesson: Use the chat facility to like, leave and reply to other students' comments.

When the online chat facility is used whilst studying online, the interactiveness of the student is increased which can lead to weaker feelings of isolation because the student is able to communicate more (Heaslip *et al*., 2013, cited in Huang, 2022).

Your comments:

b. Choose one of the tips you wrote down in Task 2c and do the following:

1. Complete the PowerPoint slide below with the tip.
2. Think about how/why your tip can help students who are studying in a Hybrid Learning environment.
3. Do some research online (in English) to find an academic source that holds the same opinion as you.
4. Write a suitable paraphrase of the information you found.
5. Complete the PowerPoint slide with your paraphrase.

Tip 4

c. Look at your paraphrase in groups and compare it with the original source. Evaluate its suitability by using the six pieces of advice in paragraph 5 of the reading text.

Task 5- Discussion

a. Discuss the following in small groups:

1. Is Hybrid Learning appealing to you? Why/why not?
2. Do you agree that Hybrid Learning can improve your grades?
3. Why might some teachers enjoy a Hybrid classroom while other teachers don't?

Academic Presentations (2)



Task 1- Discussion

a. Answer the following questions in groups of three:

1. Have you ever made an academic or commercial presentation in your own language? If so, was it successful? Did you enjoy it?

2. Have you ever made an academic or commercial presentation in English? If so, was it successful? Did you enjoy it?

b. Below are some pieces of advice about making presentations. Decide in your group if you think each piece of advice (1-9) is good or bad.

Put a ✓ for good advice and a **X** for the bad ones. Put a **?** if you are not sure.

1. Practise your presentation lots of times before you deliver it.
2. The purpose of presenting is to tell your audience about the research you have done.
3. All the information for your presentation should appear on your slides.
4. Write out your presentation and then read it in front of your audience.
5. Your PowerPoint slides need plenty of text.
6. The purpose of presenting is simply to get a good grade.
7. On your slides, images are better than text.
8. You can talk for more than your time limit if you have interesting things to say.
9. You should follow an agreed upon structure for your presentation.
10. It doesn't matter if you make grammatical mistakes as long as you communicate well.

c. Report your ideas to the class.

d. You are going to read a text that gives advice about presenting in groups of 3.

Student A: Read tips 1 and 2. Student B: Read tips 3 and 4. Student C: Read tips 5 and 6.

Read your assigned tips and make notes on the key points as you read.

SIX TIPS FOR GIVING A SUCCESSFUL ACADEMIC PRESENTATION

Tip #1: Use PowerPoint, but with care.

Images are powerful. Research shows that images help with memory and learning (Kouyoumdjian, 2012). Use images that help you to make your point. Keep your slides simple, no intricate patterns or large amounts of colour. Do not put lots of text on them, because your audience will start to read your slides and stop listening to you. Slides should have just key words on them, and you need to present the ideas orally. Never read from your slides while you are presenting!

Tip # 2: There is a formula to academic presentations. Use it.

If you are new to presenting, you might want a recipe for making presentations. This will vary slightly depending on your subject, but most presentations will follow the pattern below:

- Introduction, background, plan
- Main body, following the plan set out in first stage:
  - Point 1
  - Point 2
  - Point 3
- Conclusion
- Audience questions

Tip #3: The audience wants to hear about your research.

Although you may be giving a presentation as part of an assessment, do not forget that your listeners are there to learn about your research. While you are presenting, you are taking on the role of a teacher. Do not simply tell the audience what they already know: tell them about all the interesting things you have found out while preparing for your presentation.

Tip #4: Practice. Practice. Practice.

You should always practise your presentation before you give it. You might feel a bit self-conscious delivering your presentation to your bedroom mirror, but you need to do it again and again. This way you will be to get the timing right and it is more likely that you will be able to speak without using notes.

Tip #5: Keep to Your Time Limit

If you have a slot of ten minutes to present, prepare ten minutes of material and NO MORE. At the end of your time slot, the assessor will stop you even if you have not finished making all your points. You will not gain marks for speaking for more than the allotted time – in fact, your assessor may even deduct marks.

Tip #6: Don't Read Your Presentation

Students sometimes write out their presentation and then read it in front of the audience. Although it is understandable that you want to feel prepared and you do not want to make lots of grammar errors, it is not a good idea to read your presentation aloud. Written language usually contains more information in a fewer words than spoken language, which is why you often need to read a paragraph twice to understand all of it, and if you simply read aloud, you may lose the audience. Practise your presentation, know what you want to say, and talk to your listeners.

Adapted from:
Golash-Boza, T. (2018) *6 Tips for Giving a Fabulous Academic Presentation*. Available at: https://www.wiley.com/network/researchers/promoting-your-article/6-tips-for-giving-a-fabulous-academic-presentation (Accessed: 09 May 2020).

Reference
Kouyoumdjian, H. (2012) *Learning Through Visuals.* Available at: https://www.psychologytoday.com/gb/blog/get-psyched/201207/learning-through-visuals (Accessed: 19 May 2020).

e. Tell the rest of your group about the advice in the text. Relate it to the advice in Task 2b- were your ideas correct? Use your own words, do not read aloud from the text.

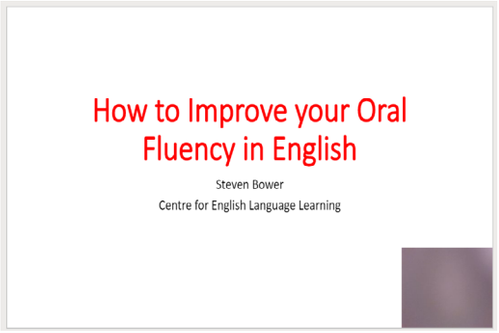
Task 2- Listening to a presentation

You are going to listen to Steven Bower, a lecturer from the Centre for English Language Learning, deliver a 10 minute presentation to learners of English.

a. Look at the title slide of the presentation and answer questions 1-4:

1. What topic is the presentation about?
2. What do you understand by the term 'oral fluency in English'?
3. What can you do to improve your speaking and pronunciation in English?
4. What techniques do you think Steven will suggest?

Title Slide



b. Listen to Steve. Put the items discussed in the presentation in the correct order. The first one has been done for you.

Two types of skill that you need to develop to become fluent in English

What you need to do to become more fluent

An issue with vocabulary learning

1 Two types of fluency.

A suggestion for learning vocabulary

Two things that you can do on your own to help with one type of fluency

c. When presenting, it can be a good idea to use cue cards that help you remember what to say. Listen again to Steven's presentation and complete gaps 1-16 in his cue cards .

1.

What is oral fluency?

Physical fluency = [1].....

[2] .....

Mental fluency = [3].....

2.

Activities for physical fluency

Activity	Purpose
1. [4]	[5]
2. [6]	

3.

Skills to develop

Production skills = [7] .....

.....

Interaction skills = [8] .....

.....

4.

Vocabulary

A lexical chunk = [9] .....

.....

Examples = [10] .....

[11] .....

5.

Advice for developing oral fluency

1. Practice a lot
2. [12]
3. [13]
4. [14]
5. [15]
6. [16]

d. Look back at the six tips you read about in Task 1. Do you think Steve did all of these things?

Task 3- Using signposting phrases when presenting

a. Signposting phrases help to guide the audience through your presentation. Match the signposting phrases in boxes A to L on the next page with the purposes 1-12 below.

1. Drawing attention to information on your slides
2. Moving from one section to the next (transitions)
3. Introducing the presentation topic
4. Ending the presentation with thanks and questions
5. Concluding
6. Outlining the overall structure
7. Expressing the purpose
8. Highlighting important points
9. Introducing a point
10. Greeting your audience and introducing yourself
11. Giving examples
12. Saying how long you will speak for and when the audience should ask you questions

Signposting phrases for presentations

A

- Hello everybody
- My name is...
- Good afternoon, everyone.

B

- I've divided the talk into [x] sections...
- First of all... Secondly... Then... Finally...
- This talk is divided into [four] main parts.

C

- I'm going to talk to you about...
- The topic of my presentation today is...

D

- My purpose/objective/aim today is...
- What I want to do today is...
- I'm here today to...

E

- My presentation/talk/lecture will take/last about 5 minutes.
- At the end of my talk, there will be a chance to ask questions.
- I'll be happy to answer any questions you have at the end of my presentation.

F

- Let me move on now to my [first] section...
- I'm going to go on now to the next section...
- OK, so, I want to talk now about...

G

- I'd like to focus particularly on...
- It's interesting to note that...
- I'd like to draw your attention to...

H

- As you can see here...
- If we look at this slide...
- This slide shows...
- If you look at the screen, you'll see...

I

- Let me give you an example...
- For instance...
- A good example of this is...

J

- Thank you very much for listening.
- If you have any questions, I'd be happy to answer them.
- So that's the end of my presentation.
- Any questions?

K

- To begin with...
- Turning then to the first point...
- My final point is...

L

- This brings us to the conclusion.
- Let me end by saying...
- In conclusion...
- To sum up...

When using signposting phrases, it is important to use your voice to stress the important words. This can help your audience to notice the signposts and keep their attention.

b. Underline the words in the signposting structures that you think need to be stressed when you say them. Example D had already been done for you.

c. Listen again to Steven's presentation. Which signposting phrases from the boxes did he use? Tick (✓) each signposting phrase you hear.

d. Choose 2-3 of the cue cards in Task 3. Imagine you are using these as PowerPoint slides in your presentation. Practice saying the information using the signposting phrases you learnt above. Don't forget to stress the important words.

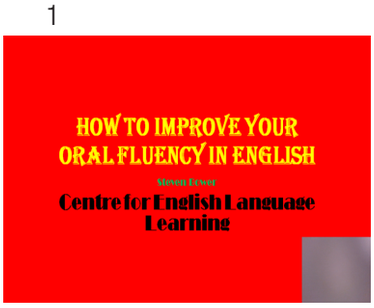
Task 4- Designing your slides

a. In pairs, think of some do's (= things you should do) and don'ts (= things you shouldn't do) when you are designing slides or other types of visuals for a presentation. Think about colours, choice of font, size of font, background colour, amount of text, visuals, and any other things you think are important.

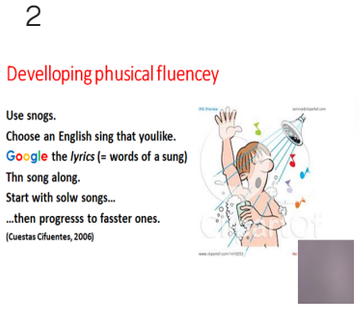
Do	Don't
• Keep slides simple	• Use lots of colours

b. Below are six PowerPoint slides. What do you think of them? What advice would you give to the person who designed them? Can you add to your list of do's and don'ts?

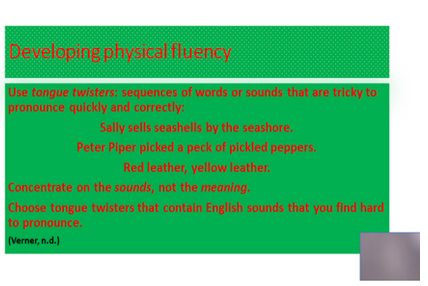
1



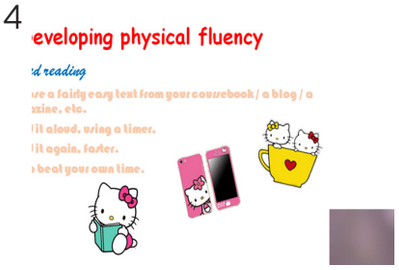
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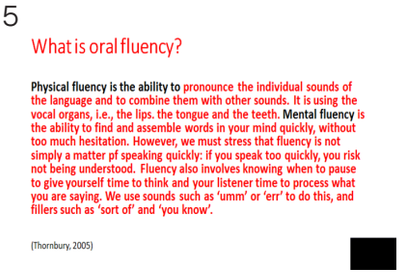
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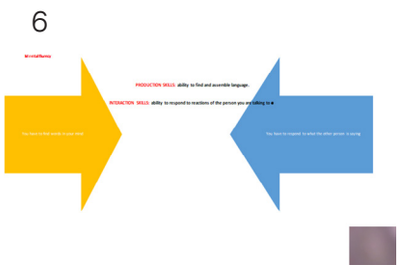
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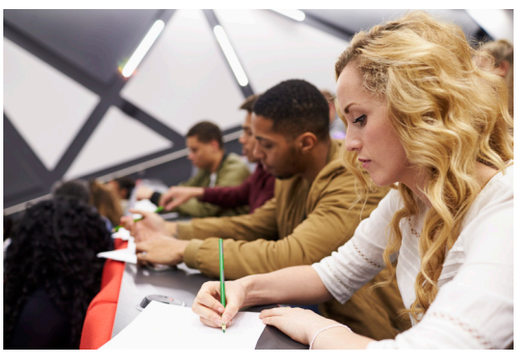
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6



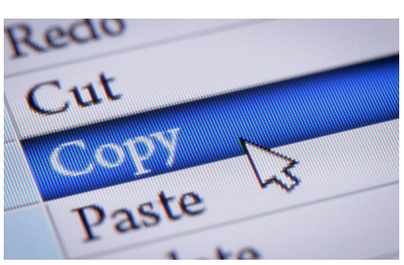
Note-taking in Lectures

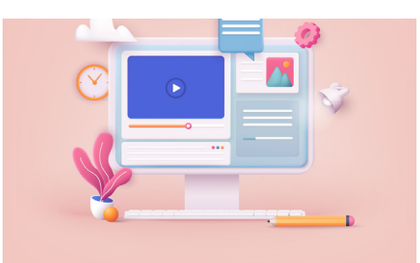


Task 1- Discussion

a. Match the phrases from in the box with the pictures they represent below.

free school meals	plagiarism	teaching methodology	online learning platforms









b. Compare your answers with a partner. Why did you choose each one?

c. Discuss the following questions in small groups:

1. Do school pupils in your country receive free school meals?
2. Why is it crucial to reference in university assignments?
3. What is an online learning platform? How could they be useful for primary school pupils?

Task 2- Lecture organisation

You are going to listen to lectures based on the topics in Task 1 and make notes on the main ideas. However, not all lecturers use the same structure to organise their information. Knowing the structure of the talk can help you to make notes in a clear way.

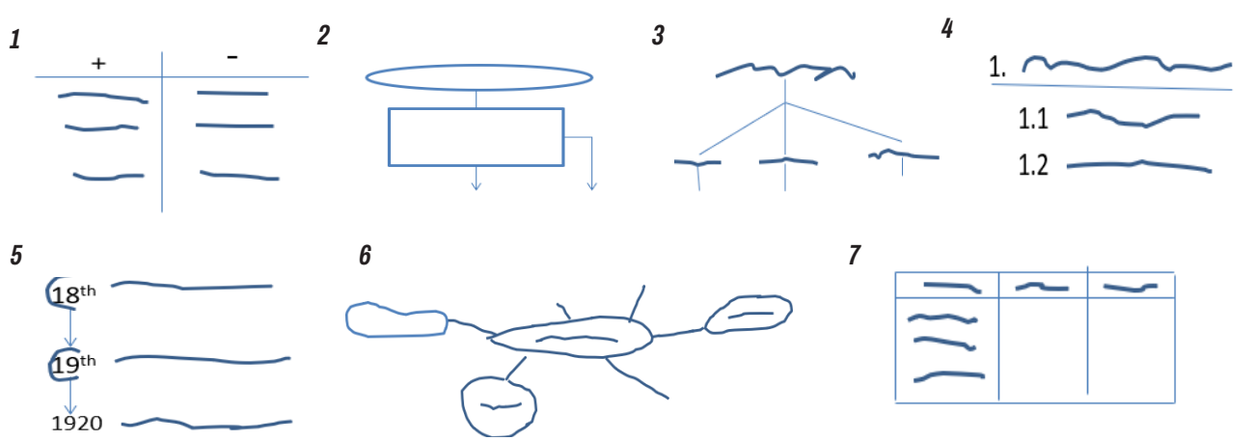
a. The following structures are possible structures that can be used in a lecture. Match the beginning with the end. The first one has been done as an example.

cause	and disadvantages
advantages	and contrast
classification	and effect
problem	supporting information
comparison	events
question	process
theories or opinions then	and solution
sequence of	and answer
stages of a	and definition

Task 3- Note-taking structures

a. The following structures in the box can be used as a way to organise notes in a lecture. Match each note-taking structure to its corresponding diagram (1-7).

flowchart spidergram table timeline
two columns tree diagram headings + notes



b. Match each note-taking structure with the lecture organisations in Task 2. You can use more than one lecture organisation for each diagram.

Task 4- Deciding on a suitable note-taking structures

a. Listen to four lecture introductions on the topics in Task 1. Which note-taking structure from Task 3 you would use to structure your notes? Look at an example below.

Example Introduction:

This afternoon I'd like to talk to you about academic culture. We will look broadly at academic culture in terms of its impacts on university assignments, teacher-student relationships, learning environments and learning methods.

Example Answer: spidergram (because the lecturer will discuss 4 different aspects)



Task 5- Predicting Content

a. Listen to each introduction again. After each introduction, discuss and complete the following points with a partner:

i. What is the lecture about?

ii. What areas of the topic will it focus on?

iii. What information do you predict the lecturer will discuss?

b. Make an outline for your notes on a separate piece of paper.

Taking effective notes from lectures (1): Using abbreviations

Using abbreviations to take notes

Why use abbreviations?

It is difficult during lectures to listen and write at the same time. When you stop to write something down, you might miss something else which is important. Abbreviations and symbols can help to make note-taking faster. The is same for taking notes while reading.

Which words can be abbreviated?

Almost any word can be abbreviated. It is a good idea to abbreviate longer, common words that appear in your lectures.

How can a word be abbreviated?

There are no right or wrong ways to abbreviate a word. You need to find a style that you are comfortable with. No one else will see your lecture notes so as long as you can understand the meaning, it's OK!

Some people like to use one of the following methods:

1. Use **the beginning** of the word:
   - government: gov.
   - politics: pol.
   - education: educ.
   - approximately: approx.

2. Use **the beginning of the word plus the last letter**:
   - government: govt
   - international: interl

3. Put a **comma before the last letter** of the word:
   - gov't
   - inter'l

4. **Omit vowels**
   - problem: prbm
   - quality: qlty
   - teacher: tchr

Task 1- Using abbreviations

a. What do you think the following abbreviations mean? Compare your ideas with a partner.

schl uni pls bus hlth dep stats

b. How could you abbreviate these words and phrases? Remember, there is no correct way.

Word/Phrase	*Abbreviation*
a. for instance, for example	
b. etcetera, and so on	
c. difference, different, difficulty, difficult	
d. important, importance	
e. maximum	
f. minimum	
g. possible, possibility	
h. problem, probably, probability	

c. Choose some common terminology from your field of study. What abbreviations could you use for the terms in your listening and reading note-taking?

Taking effective notes from lectures (2): Symbols

a. Another way to make notes quickly is by using a symbol instead of the word. Match the symbols in the table with the meaning. The first one has been done for you.

a. →	equals, same as
b. ←	increase, more, go up, up
c. ↓	much greater, much more than
d. ↑	leads to, causes- showing result
e. >>	greater, more than
f. ≥	caused by, because of – showing cause
g. ≤	less than
h. =	decrease, less, go down, down
i. ≠	does not equal, different from

Advice

- Note taking is personal to you. Choose the method you find easiest.
- Use only abbreviations and symbols that you will remember easily. Too many can make your notes difficult to understand.
- Make sure that your abbreviations and symbols always mean the same thing.
- Keep a separate list of your abbreviations and their meanings so that you can refer to them in the future if necessary.
- If you start using a new abbreviation, add it to the list.

Task 1- Taking notes from a short lecture (i)

a. Look at the key words for Lecture 1 on **Referencing** in the green box below. If you are unsure of the meaning, check them in a dictionary.

b. What abbreviations could you use?

committing an (academic) offense | well-balanced argument | bibliography

think critically | synthesising

c. Using the outline you prepared, listen to the lecture and complete your notes.

d. Compare your notes with a partner and answer questions 1-3:

1. Did you note down the same information?
2. Did you use the same note-taking structure?
3. Do you think taking notes in this structure has helped to make your notes easier to understand?

e. Your teacher will now show you some example notes. How much of the lecture did you understand?

Task 2- Taking notes from a short lecture (ii)

a. Look at the key words for Lecture 2 on ***The use of learning platforms outside of primary school*** in the purple box. If you are unsure of the meaning, check them in a dictionary.

b. What abbreviations could you use?

school boards	autonomy	digital literacy skills	pace	attainment

c. Using the outline you prepared, listen to the lecture and complete your notes.

d. Compare your notes with a partner and answer questions 1-3:

1. Did you note down the same information?
2. Did you use the same note-taking structure?
3. Do you think taking notes in this structure has helped to make your notes easier to understand?

e. Your teacher will now show you some example notes. How much of the lecture did you understand?

f. Choose one of the lectures from Task 1 or Task 2. Use your notes or the example notes to present the ideas in the lecture to your partner.

Grammar Focus- Articles

a. Read the following excerpts from Lecture 1. For each noun (1-8), discuss with a partner why **'a'**, '**the**' or '**no article**' have been used.

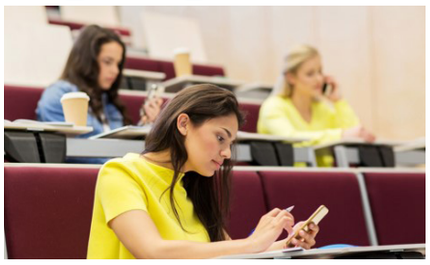
- If you use someone else's work and don't include [1] a reference in your work, you are committing [2] an academic offense. You could fail [3] an assessment, [4] a module or even your course so it really is imperative that you do it.
- When you include [5] support, you must include a reference.
- [6] The third point to consider is that as part of your assessment, your lecturers will want to know how much you have read on [7] the topic in order to complete your assignment.
- Through [8] the in-text references, you are able to show that you can think critically.

b. Turn to the Grammar Reference section at the back of the book. Read the grammar explanation. Were your ideas correct?

c. Complete the gaps in sentences 1-8 with 'a', 'an', 'the', or 'Ø' (no article).

1. Do you fancy [a]..... coffee before [b]..... lecture? [c]..... cafeteria in [d]..... Hugh Aston Building will be open.
2. I don't usually like [a]..... English food, but [b]..... cakes are really good.
3. If you need help with [a]..... assignment that's due on Friday, send me [b]..... email.
4. Don't worry about making [a]..... mistakes. [b]..... teachers at CELL are all really kind!
5. We went to London last weekend. We went on [a]..... London Eye and fed [b]..... pigeons in Trafalgar Square.
6. [a]..... most expensive meal I've ever eaten was at [b]..... Shard in London.
7. If you're going into town, could you get me [a]..... bottle of cough medicine? I think I'm getting [b]..... cold.
8. This is [a]..... most boring book I've ever had to read. I don't know how [b]..... author expects anyone to understand their ideas.

Managing Digital Distractions



Task 1- Discussion

a. Check the meaning of the words in bold, then answer questions 1-5 about your mobile phone habits:

1. Do you check your mobile phone as soon as you wake up for ***missed calls*** or ***messages***?
2. Do you check ***social media*** as soon as you wake up?
3. If you wake up in the night, do you ever check your phone?
4. Do you ***scroll*** through your phone before you go to sleep at night?
5. Do you scroll through your phone whilst watching TV or a film?
6. Do you ever find yourself ***doom scrolling***?

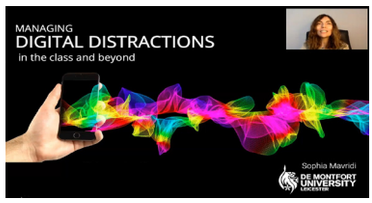
b. Compare your habits in small groups.

c. Check the meaning of the words in bold, then decide if the following statements (1-11) are **True** or **False** for you?

1. I check my texts and chat messages in class.
2. I check my social media in class.
3. I use my phone in class for academic purposes e.g. translation
4. My device ***distracts*** me when I'm in class.
5. I worry that my friends might be having fun somewhere and I'm ***missing out***.
6. I feel lonely without my device.
7. I feel bored without my device.
8. Social media gives me ***instant gratification***.
9. Sometimes I think the online world is more interesting than the offline world.
10. My generation could be described as ***'smartphone zombies'***.
11. I think smartphones should be banned from university classrooms.

d. Discuss your answers in small groups.

Task 2- Listening (mini-lecture Part 1)



a. You are going to listen to a talk by Sophia Mavridi, who is a digital learning specialist and a lecturer at De Montfort University. Look at the title of her talk. What do you think she will talk about?

Glossary

Skills (n): *abilities that you can develop and improve with practice.*

Competencies (n): *an ability to do something successfully or efficiently.*

b. Listen to the introduction of Sophia's talk. Check your answers to Task 2a. What will she discuss?

c. Read the sentences that Sophia uses and predict the answers to the questions in each box.

"So, technology has changed teaching and learning for good. We can find information at the click of a button and use it for..."

1. What can we use technology for?

"However, along with this massive potential, technology is also chronically distracting us. Teachers are concerned about..."

2. What are teachers concerned about?

"So, a relatively recent study on students' perceptions of digital distractions – it was published in 2016 – asked around 700 college students in 26 states of America..."

3. What do the percentages refer to? Connect the % with the activity (a-c):

97%	a. use device because they are bored / want to connect to friends
63 %	b. say using devices is distracting
89%	c. use devices up to 30+ times in class

"So, these college students said that one of the leading reasons that they use their devices in class for non-class purposes is because they want to stay connected".

4. Why should we not call this need to stay connected an 'addiction'?

5. Why are students so attached to their mobile devices?

"We're now hardly surprised to see people walking down the street looking at their phones. Some call them 'the distracted generation' or even 'smartphone zombies'..."

6. Give an explanation for 'FOMO'

d. Listen to Sophia's talk and check your answers.

e. Compare your completed notes with a partner.

Task 3- Listening (mini-lecture Part 2)

In the second part of Sophia's talk, she uses idioms (in bold) in the following sentences:

"It takes about 25 minutes ***to get back into the swing of things*** after you've been distracted. 25 minutes ***to*** really ***get back in the zone***. This is quite serious".

a. What do you think the idioms mean? Try to work out the meaning from the context. Then, look them up in a dictionary to check.

b. Ask and answer the following questions in small groups:

1. Imagine you are in a lesson and you spend a few minutes chatting on your phone. How long does it usually take you to get back into the swing of the lesson?

2. How do you get in the zone when you need to do homework or an assignment?

c. Listen to Part 2 of Sophia's talk and answer questions 1-3.

1. What is the effect of being distracted by devices in class?

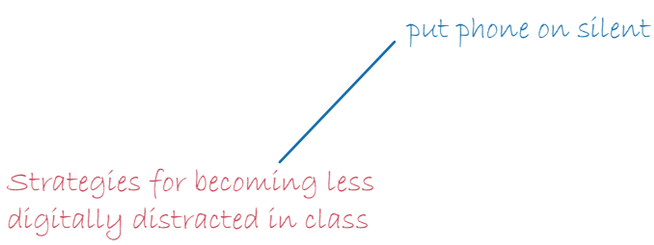
2. Why is it important NOT to ban devices from classrooms?

3. What skills do students in the 21st century need to develop in addition to using social media, editing photos, etc.?

Task 4- Discussion

a. Do you think you are too easily distracted by your phone in class? Discuss your ideas in a small group.

b. Sophia ends her talk by asking the following question: "***What can you do to manage your digital distractions?"***. Brainstorm different ways in which you can manage your digital distractions in class.



c. Compare your brainstorms in small groups. For each suggestion, answer the following questions:

1. What are the advantages?
2. Are there any disadvantages?
3. How realistic is the suggestion?

d. Look again at your suggestions, are there any that you think you should implement yourself?

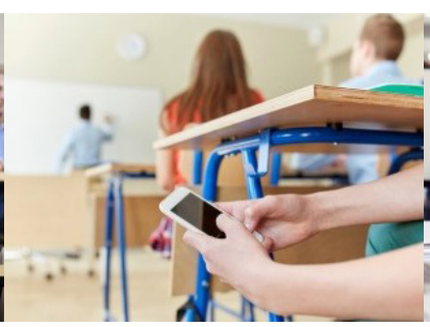
e. Discuss questions 1-4 in small groups. Give reasons for your answers.

1. Do you think teachers are right to be concerned about students using devices in class?
2. Do you think devices should be banned in university classrooms? Why/why not?
3. Do you mind if a classmate you are working with starts to use their phone?
4. Do you think it is the teacher's responsibility to try and get students back in the zone?

Task 5- Reflection

a. Think about what you have discussed and learnt in today's class and answer the following questions:

1. Do you think you have FOMO? Why/Why not?
2. Do you think you are too easily distracted by your phone in your own time when working on assignments? Why/Why not?
3. Think again about the strategies you discussed in Task 4b. Do you think you will try to implement any of them? Why/Why not?

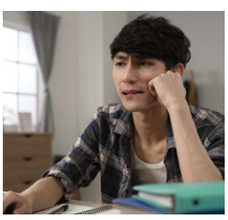




Strengths and Weaknesses



Task 1- Discussion

a. Haoran has an online tutorial today with his teacher, Andrew. Andrew has asked Haoran to reflect on what he has learned on this pre-sessional course. Read about what he's thinking.



Reading's difficult, I'm really bad at it... I don't know enough vocabulary. And learning new vocabulary takes a long time, there's so much of it! I know my speaking is very poor as well, because I can't think of the words I need, and I make a lot of mistakes... Andrew asked me how I can improve my speaking.... I don't know! Maybe watch English movies with subtitles? I need to write better as well, so maybe watching movies could help? I don't know... it's all a bit confusing.

b. Answer questions 1-3 and compare your ideas in groups.

1. Do you ever feel the way Haoran is feeling?
2. What does Haoran think are his main difficulties?
3. Do you think he is being realistic about the problems?

Task 2- Listening

a. Haoran is attending his tutorial with Andrew. Listen to Part 1 of Haoran's tutorial and complete the notes below with the ideas that they discuss.

Topic	Andrew's comments	How Haoran feels	What can help?
Presentation			
Writing		Thinks about mistakes too much.	
Speaking in groups			

b. Compare your answers with a partner.

c. At the end of the tutorial, Andrew suggests a way for Haoran to reflect on his learning. He suggests six steps that you can take to become a reflective learner. The steps are listed below but they are not in the correct order. Listen to Part 2 of Haoran's tutorial and number the steps from 1-6 in the order that Andrew suggests.

Steps for Becoming a Reflective Learner

Step ____ : Check your progress

Step ____ : Be specific

Step ____ : Plan small actions

Step ____ : Stay positive

Step ____ : Write short notes

Step ____ : Look back after each lesson

Task 3- Language to talk about strengths and weaknesses

a. After Haoran's tutorial, Andrew writes Haoran some feedback. Match the titles to a paragraph (1-7) of Haoran's feedback on the next page. **The first title has been done for you as an example.**

Titles

i. Movies can help, but use them actively Paragraph 5

ii. Don't be afraid to ask for help if you don't understand

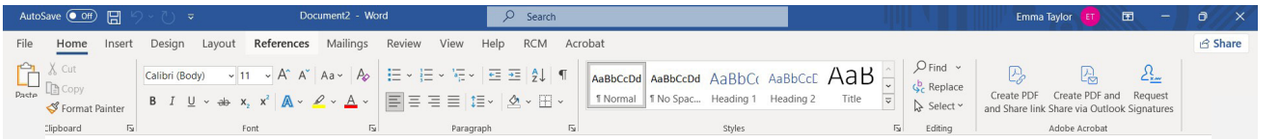
iii. Don't try to learn everything at once

iv. Good writing needs more than just new words

v. Speaking improves through confidence and daily practice

vi. You are already reflecting and that's a strong beginning

vii. Find a way of learning new words that suits you



Student : Haoran Chan P Number: P4281369

PSB Feedback

1. You've already made a good start by noticing your main difficulties and asking questions about them. This is the first step in reflective learning: becoming aware of what is hard and what you want to improve, so you've made progress in understanding this.

2. You say that you don't feel confident with reading because you don't know enough vocabulary. This is a clear observation, but it may help to be more specific. What kinds of words cause problems — academic words or everyday words? Try keeping a short list of words after each reading task and review it regularly. This is more realistic and effective than trying to learn all the new vocabulary in the text.

3. You have noticed that it takes a lot of time to learn new vocabulary. That's true for everyone, but reflection can help you find methods that suit you. For example, you could note down five useful words each day from your reading and use them in sentences. Learning a few words well is more effective than trying to memorise too many. That'll help you to feel more confident.

4. You say that your speaking is poor because you find it difficult to think of the words you need, and you need to practise this more, even though you find it difficult. That shows good insight, but be careful not to be too pessimistic. You probably know more words than you think; anxiety can block them. Try using phrases to give yourself thinking time in speaking practice – again, that will help you to feel more confident.

5. Watching English films with English subtitles can help — not by itself, only if you reflect on it. Notice new phrases, repeat lines aloud, and write down expressions you could use in real situations. Don't use Chinese subtitles – focus on spoken and written words in English!

6. As for writing, films might give you some new vocabulary, but good writing also needs planning and reading models. Although you think you are confused about grammar, I think you are doing OK – I think you still struggle with organising your ideas. Rereading the academic texts in your PSB coursebook and noticing structure, linking words, and paragraph style will be more useful for university writing than watching movies.

7. You told me that you are unsure about what reporting verbs are. Remember- teachers are here to help you if you need clarification. When you include a writer's ideas in your essay, you can say things like 'Smith states that… ' and 'Smith points out that…', and so on – those are reporting verbs. It's good if you can use a few different ones; 'Smith argues that…' if Smith is trying to persuade you of an idea, or 'Smith concludes that…' if he is telling you what he has decided after doing some research himself or reading research by others.

To sum up:

- You are aware of your difficulties — that's a strength.
- Work on being more specific and realistic about your goals.
- Avoid thinking "I'm poor at everything"; instead, plan small, regular actions.
- Reflect each week on what worked best — that is how reflective learning leads to progress.

b. Look at the highlighted parts in Haoran's feedback and the underlined phrases in each. Which underlined phrases are followed by:

1. a noun or a noun phrase *e.g. note-taking, articles, speaking in small groups*?
2. a clause *e.g. I remember new vocabulary / I want to improve my speaking*?
3. an infinitive *e.g. watch, understand*

c. How do you know whether to use ***a noun/noun phrase***, ***a clause*** or ***an infinitive*** after the underlined phrases?

d. Look at the following sentence beginnings and possible endings. Decide which endings can match with the sentence beginnings. There is more than one possibility in each case.

1. I've made progress in...
2. I still find it difficult to...
3. I'm quite confident with...
4. I need to work on...
5. I'm confused about...
6. I've noticed that...
7. I still struggle with...

A. understanding Learning Zone videos.
B. interacting in breakout rooms / groups.
C. write clear paragraphs.
D. I organise my essays well.
E. referencing correctly.
F. how to summarise texts.
G. preparing for tutorials.
H. I participate more in open class discussions.
I. linking ideas clearly.
J. I express my ideas orally in class.
K. taking notes quickly.
L. how to use articles more accurately.
M. my essays are clearer with planning.
N. time management for assignments.
O. read academic texts.
P. I understand the main points in listening tasks.

Task 4- Reflection

a. Over the last few weeks, you've learnt a lot about academic English. Look at the list of language skills you've covered on this course below and number each topic on a scale from 1-5 to show how you feel about them (1 = I feel confident about this, 5 = I don't feel at all confident about this).

Academic Skills	*Language Skills*	*Grammar*
• Presentations • Avoiding plagiarism • Essay structure • Paragraph structure • Referencing • Reporting verbs • Taking notes in lectures • Text analysis • Seminar skills	• Reading for gist and detail • Listening for gist and detail • Speaking in discussions and tutorials • Writing essays	• Articles

b. Complete sentences 1-6 so that they are true for you.

1. I've made progress in...
2. I've realised that...
3. I'm still not sure about...
4. I've noticed that...
5. I need more practice with...
6. I think I need to...

c. Compare your sentences in small groups. Explain more about your strengths and weaknesses by considering the following questions:

Strengths

1. What helped you to make progress in this area?
2. Did you already have this strength before starting this course?

Weaknesses

1. Why do you think this area is a weakness?
2. What could you do to improve in this area?

Grammar Reference

Articles

The uses of English articles are complicated, and the rules given here are simple ones. You will not usually be misunderstood if you use articles wrongly or if you omit them, but it is a good idea to pay attention to them and try to get them right, especially in your writing.

Basic rules

1. If the person you are talking to knows which thing you are talking about, use **'*the*'** before the noun or noun phrase:

- Did you go to the lecture this morning?
  (You know which lecture I mean)
- I left my phone in the library.
  (You know which library I mean)
- Could you pass me the sugar?
  (You know which sugar I mean)

2. If we can't say 'you know which X I mean', use **'*a / an*'**:

- There's a good film on this evening.
- I need an envelope.
- There's a huge spider in the bath!

3. Don't use an article with plural nouns or uncountable nouns (compare with point 6).

- I'm scared of spiders.
  *(Not *I'm scared of the spiders.)*
- I don't take sugar in my tea.
  *(Not *I don't take the sugar in my tea.)*

4. Known information and unknown information.

- I'm going to the cafeteria for lunch.
  (You know which cafeteria I mean.)
- Is there a cafeteria in this building?
  (Any cafeteria)
- I really didn't enjoy the film.
  (You know which film I mean)
- Shall we go and see a film this evening?
  (The speaker doesn't say which film)
- Where's the tea I bought this morning?
  (The speaker says which tea)
- I don't like tea.
  (Any tea)

5. We don't usually use 'the' when we are speaking generally:

- Books are expensive.
  (books in general)
- I'm scared to death of spiders
  (spiders in general)

6. Use **'the'** to refer to specific things

- Books in bookshops are usually expensive the books on Amazon are cheaper.
- Spiders in England are usually pretty small, but the spiders I saw in Thailand were huge!

7. Use **'the'** when talking about a unique thing (there is only 1)

- We visited the Great Wall when we were in China.
- I haven't seen the sun for days.

8. Use **'the'** with superlatives

- This is the longest essay I've ever written!
- That was the most difficult book I've ever read!
- What's the best Chinese restaurant in Leicester?

Adapted from:
Swan, M. (2005) *Practical English Usage.* 3rd ed. OUP.

Audio scripts

Sustainable Development Goals- Task 5

Part 1

Hi everyone. So, what I'm here to talk to you about is the United Nations' Sustainable Development Goals. And today, I will be talking about three key areas. Firstly, I will talk to you about the background of the Sustainable Development Goals or as we call them the 'SDGs'. I will include information about what the SDGs are and their aims. Secondly, we will look at why we at De Montfort University are so interested in these SDGs. And finally, we will look at some of the challenges of implementing them.

However, before we go deeper into these three key areas, I'd like you to think for a moment about the biggest challenges that your country faces. Does your country struggle with environmental issues? How about issues of politics or social justice? What about infrastructure such as roads, hospitals and education? We all have different issues we feel passionate about and that we see as having a big influence in our countries. However, it is these challenges that the United Nations' Sustainable Development Goals are all about.

Part 2

So what are they? Well, there are 17 goals in total and they were agreed by the countries of the United Nations- that's basically all the countries in the world getting together. Their aim is to agree on a shared agenda of what all the nations want to accomplish by around the year 2030. This means that if the goals are achieved, many aspects of the world's problems could be improved or even solved by 2030.

Some of the goals are people-orientated such as eradicating poverty and hunger, people being healthy, improving education and reducing inequalities. However, there are also environment-orientated goals, such as preserving biodiversity on land or at sea and having a safe climate in which to develop our civilization. There are also economic goals which will enable these things to happen, so having good processes of innovation and developing infrastructure is going to benefit everyone.

So, this is an internationally agreed agenda and, despite all the differences between the countries in the world, they still managed to get together and agree that these things are good things that we should work together and work towards common goals. As I mentioned before, there are 17 goals but there are also around 170 targets that explain each goal in more detail and how the United Nations want to achieve them.

Now you might be thinking 'OK, that's interesting. What does it have to do with us?' Well, here at DMU, this is actually a big focus for us. We've decided in our latest and strategic plan to make these 17 goals the lens through which we see the activity of the university. As a university, we're not here to make a profit, we're here for the good of our society. We see ourselves as being there for the public good. So, we believe that by thinking of these goals, it is a really helpful way of telling the story of what we're trying to achieve. Whether that's through our research, through our teaching or through our partnership work, either in the city of Leicester, elsewhere or even internationally. We have a commitment to link these goals to the activities that we're doing. And that's why you're hearing about them on this course.

Part 3

So, let's move on to thinking about some of the challenges of achieving these 17 goals. As you might tell, the challenges the world faces are not simple. They cannot be solved quickly and easily. Every one of these goals is really difficult to achieve. They are complex issues-they're evolving issues, and generally lots of different people need to collaborate in order to make change happen. For example, it's not something that governments can do alone. We also need businesses to do their part and of course the general public.

A good example of how everyone needs to work together is by looking at cycle infrastructure in a city. Now, there are many benefits of having more cycle lanes. For example, if the number of cyclists travelling to work increases, it will reduce the number of cars on the road and in effect, reduce pollution. It will improve the cyclist's health, which could save the government money in the long-term. Therefore, it seems a logical solution to have cycle lanes in a busy city.

Now, you might think that putting in lots of new cycle paths around a city is a simple thing. However, it can be very challenging. Firstly, it can be unpopular for civic leaders to replace roads for cars with routes for cyclists; therefore, we need a collaborative approach from the technological side. We would also need support from the public because the cycle paths could be right in front of people's houses and could cause disruption. We would also need the government to come up with and implement any new laws and new rules. So doing one relatively small improvement to a city really involves a lot of collaboration. And any sustainable development challenge is similar - lots of people need to work together to make change happen.

So, we've introduced these goals as, you know, good things for the future that we can all agree on. However, even though there is broad agreement, and all governments in the United Nations signed up to agree to pursue the same agenda, that doesn't mean we shouldn't think critically about these goals. Because there's a lot to discuss. And at university, our goal is to think critically and not just accept what we're told.

So, there you go. I've just given you a five-minute introduction to the SDGs. You'll hear a lot more about them at De Montfort University. These are ideas that we can all try and contribute to and try to think critically about.

Stereotypes- Task 3

Teacher It's not easy presenting in English for the first time (Student's name) but I'm sure I can help.

Student Oh I hope so (Teacher's name). I'm struggling with what to put in my introduction. Can you give me some advice?

Teacher Sure. All academic presentations require the same format so once you have done one, you can do any.

Student Oh, that's good to know.

Teacher So firstly you need to welcome the audience and introduce yourself. It's good to be polite. Then of course you need to introduce briefly the topic of your presentation. You could give some background information to set the scene or some people like to include a 'hook'.

Student A hook?

Teacher Yes, it's something used to attract the audience to get their attention. It could be a shocking statistic related to your chosen topic or an interesting fact or opinion. Some people even like to play a short video clip but you must be careful if you choose to do this. It needs to be completely relevant and not eat in to your time. Your teacher wants to hear your ideas, not watch a video.

Student Oh, haha. Of course. What about asking the audience a question to get their attention?

Teacher Yes, that's an option. But make sure it just requires a yes or no answer, where the audience can simply raise their hand. If the question needs a full reply or just a one word answer, some audience members might be too shy to answer and you are left with an awkward silence.

Student Ooh no you don't want that.

Teacher But don't forget to provide a justification for your topic.

Student A justification? What do you mean by that?

Teacher You need to tell the audience why you think your presentation topic is important. Perhaps something happened recently and the media are talking about it or it is currently being debated in society or maybe it's just really important information for the audience members to know because it will help them in their lives or to develop more of an understanding of something.

Student Oh right, OK.

Teacher But remember, although the hook, the background and the justification are useful to the presentation, it should be quite brief. Don't spend too much time on it.

Student Alright.

Teacher So after you've introduced the topic, you need to go through the structure of your presentation. Tell your audience how many sections are in your talk and what those sections are. It's the same as when you're writing an essay introduction. Your audience needs to know what you are going to talk about and in what order.

Student OK great. So is that it?

Teacher Haha no. Some presenters often think that this is a good place to stop but there are three more things to include.

Student Oh really? OK.

Teacher You should make sure you say how long you will be speaking for. It doesn't have to be straight after the outline but you do need to mention it somewhere.

Student OK.

Teacher And then you tell the audience when to ask you questions. So something like, "If you have any questions, I'd be happy to answer them at the end".

Student Is that what you recommend? Answering questions at the end?

Teacher Yes, definitely. If you allow your audience to ask you questions during the presentation you might not be able to answer or your flow could be interrupted.

Student Oh OK. And that's it? There's a lot to include!

Teacher Haha nearly there. Just one last thing. Any idea what it is?

Student Hmmm, you've mentioned the topic, background, a hook, a justification, timing, questions… there can't be anything else surely?

Teacher Just one important thing. Link your introduction to the next section by using a transition. So say something like, "OK. Let's move on to the first part of my talk which is about…". And then you can change your slide.

Student OK. Wow there's a lot to include. Thanks so much for your advice. I'm glad I booked an appointment…

Stereotypes- Task 4

Good morning everyone. Thank you for joining me here today. I am going to spend the next ten minutes speaking to you about the causes and effects of stereotyping in the mass media.

I think this is an important topic to discuss at this time because only last year, the UK's Advertising Standards Agency issued a new ruling which prohibits adverts from containing social stereotypes. If an advert does contain a social stereotype, it is banned. And this has been the case for some companies such as Mondelez International which owns Philadelphia a popular soft cheese and the car manufacturer Volkswagen whose advert for the new eGolf model was also banned. So I think looking at the effects of stereotyping in the mass media is particularly prudent.

My presentation is divided into three key parts. Firstly, I will show you some examples of stereotypes in popular UK TV shows and then I will discuss the two main reasons why such stereotypes occur. Finally I will look at the effects of these stereotypes and their impact on social attitudes.

If you have any questions, I'd be happy to answer them at the end.

OK. So one stereotype you definitely would have seen on TV if you watch BBC sitcoms is…

Hybrid Learning- Task 2a

Good afternoon everyone. It's great to see so many of you here with me in this classroom and over 60 students with us online- that's fantastic. And this is actually what we are here to discuss today- the fact that the way you will access and participate in lessons here at DMU has changed. You can now access and participate in a lecture or seminar on-campus face-to-face, or online and this is what we now call Hybrid Learning. It all started as a result of the COVID-19 pandemic where all lessons were moved online. We actually had a lot of success with teaching online and research suggests that allowing students the flexibility to learn online and face-to-face can actually improve grades- so- we are allowing students this option here at DMU, which is great! So, I am here today to go through some of the benefits and challenges of Hybrid Learning. You will then work together in groups to produce some useful advice for your fellow students on how to deal with Hybrid Learning and hopefully by the end of this seminar, you will feel prepared for your studies here at De Montfort University.

Hybrid Learning- Task 2b

Good afternoon everyone. It's great to see so many of you here with me in this classroom and over 60 students with us online- that's fantastic. And this is actually what we are here to discuss today- the fact that the way you will access and participate in lessons here at DMU has changed. You can now access and participate in a lecture or seminar on-campus face-to-face, or online and this is what we now call Hybrid Learning. It all started as a result of the COVID-19 pandemic where all lessons were moved online. We actually had a lot of success with teaching online and research suggests that allowing students the flexibility to learn online and face-to-face can actually improve grades- so- we are allowing students this option here at DMU, which is great! So, I am here today to go through some of the benefits and challenges of Hybrid Learning. You will then work together in groups to produce some useful advice for your fellow students on how to deal with Hybrid Learning and hopefully by the end of this seminar, you will feel prepared for your studies here at De Montfort University.

So, let's look at the positive aspects firstly of Hybrid Learning. Well as I have just mentioned, you are given the flexibility in the way you study. If you learn best at a desk, in a classroom, surrounded by other students doing the same thing, fantastic, come to class on campus. But if you are the kind of person who prefers to learn whilst sitting in your own comfortable chair or sofa with a cup of coffee- then fine, stay at home. Well actually, it doesn't have to be at home; you could attend class from a friend's house, or anywhere really as long as it's quiet. This is because you will be expected to participate in the lesson so noisy places should be avoided. Also, if you live away from campus, hybrid lessons give you the flexibility of not having to travel to and from campus. This saves you time and money. It's all about knowing how you learn best. If you are in the best environment for you, you will learn better.

Another huge benefit is that hybrid lessons are so much more inclusive than traditional methods. For example, some students with disabilities can find coming on campus for a few hours quite taxing and therefore being given the option to access the lesson from their homes is hugely convenient. Also, students with learning disabilities such as dyslexia, dysgraphia etc. can make use of assistive technologies that are easily available on many platforms and may feel more comfortable attending online.

Another way in which hybrid lessons are more inclusive is that they can actually allow more students to participate. Let me explain. So traditionally in a lecture for example, the teacher speaks, and the students listen and make notes. At the end, the lecturer invites questions. And this is great if you are a confident speaker. But what if you have a question, but are too shy to ask… Well if you access the lecture online, you can type your question into the chat box. In this way, you don't have all the other students looking at you as you ask and therefore, this could encourage more students to ask their questions. You can also interact with what the lecturer or a classmate says via comments without interrupting them while they speak. Just remember, there is nothing to stop a student who is physically in the lesson also asking a question or making a comment through the chat function… It also means you could ask your question as you think of it rather than waiting until the end. This active engagement in the lesson can really keep your attention for longer and help you to retain the information more easily.

Another way in which hybrid lessons are more inclusive is that they can actually allow more students to participate. Let me explain. So traditionally in a lecture for example, the teacher speaks, and the students listen and make notes. At the end, the lecturer invites questions. And this is great if you are a confident speaker. But what if you have a question, but are too shy to ask… Well if you access the lecture online, you can type your question into the chat box. In this way, you don't have all the other students looking at you as you ask and therefore, this could encourage more students to ask their questions. You can also interact with what the lecturer or a classmate says via comments without interrupting them while they speak. Just remember, there is nothing to stop a student who is physically in the lesson also asking a question or making a comment through the chat function… It also means you could ask your question as you think of it rather than waiting until the end. This active engagement in the lesson can really keep your attention for longer and help you to retain the information more easily.

Though obviously, if you decide to attend your lecture or seminar online, there are some negative aspects you should be aware of. Firstly, depending on whether your classmates have their cameras on or off, you may not always be able to see the other people in the online class. If you are having a group discussion and your group members have their cameras off, it can be harder to understand their ideas because you have to rely on just your listening skills. Of course, many classes have a cameras-on policy so that students can engage more with the lesson. When you can see people, you can use their facial expressions and hand gestures to help you to understand if they are agreeing or disagreeing for example. You could even read their lips as they are speaking to help you understand what they are saying. But even if there is a cameras-on policy, some people may have connectivity issues which may make their sound and video unstable and as a result communication

may not always be easy. So, this is definitely something to be aware of.

Also, if you're studying at home, there are so many more distractions. If you are listening to a lecture, you might think, 'oh, I'll go and make myself a cup of tea' or 'I'll just tidy my desk' at the same time as listening and then your full attention is lost and you might miss important points. And phones… on campus in a lesson, it is much harder to check your emails, chat with friends and play games if your teacher is right there in front of you. But at home, you need to have your own discipline to stop yourself from getting distracted.

The last thing I want to mention is your experience at DMU. If you spend too much time at home, you won't get the full experience of being at a UK university. DMU has a buzzing campus, full of students from a huge range of backgrounds and cultures and with lots of different pop up events going on around the campus, so if you spend a lot of time at home, you'll miss out. So my message is this. Hybrid Learning is great. It gives you greater flexibility in the way you learn and is inclusive to allow all students to participate but please, don't stay at home all the time and when you do, have your cameras on and try to manage your digital distractions.

Right then. What I'd like you to do now is to work in small groups of 4 or 5 and prepare a short presentation that you will deliver to another group. In this presentation, you'll need to come up with some advice for learning online effectively. OK, before you do this, are there any questions? Oh yes, I can see 10 in the chat box already…

Academic Presentations- Task 3

Hello. My name is Stephen Bower and I am a tutor at the Centre for English Language Learning at De Montfort University. And I'm going to talk to you about ways of improving oral fluency.

I've divided the talk into five sections. So first of all I'm going to give a definition of fluency. And then I'm gonna talk about how you can use songs to improve your oral fluency and how you can use tongue twisters- I'll explain what tongue twisters are. Then, I'm gonna talk about vocabulary learning, and how you can learn phrases to umm to become more fluent. And finally I'm going to insist that you have to speak, you have to practice oral fluency. Alright so let me move on now to the first section which is a definition of oral fluency.

So, what do we mean by fluency? Well, we can divide it into two kinds of fluency. There's physical fluency and mental fluency. Now physical fluency is your ability to pronounce the individual sounds of English or of the language that you're learning. And there's also the ability to combine sounds. And by mental fluency we mean the ability to find and assemble words in your mind fairly quickly.

Now if you're speaking your own language, this is never a problem or hardly ever a problem- it's very easy to do. But if you're speaking a foreign language it's quite difficult sometimes to find the words that you want to say. It's not simply a question of speaking quickly though- we do need to think about the use of pauses because if you speak too fast, people won't understand you. And the use of what we call 'fillers'. Fillers are sounds like 'err' and 'umm' that we often use when we are trying to think of what we want to say next. And then little phrases such as 'you know' and 'sort of', which don't really mean very much but they give us time to think about what we want to say next and we give the listener time to process what we're saying.

OK, so, I want to talk now about developing physical fluency. And one way you can do this is to use songs. And this is a very easy. You just choose a song in English that you like. And you Google the lyrics (the lyrics are the words of the song) and it's very easy to find most lyrics of songs online. And then you simply sing along. And this will give you lots of practice in getting your vocal organs (that's your lips, your teeth, your tongue) into the right positions to produce English sounds and to combine the sounds. And you can start with slow songs and as you get a bit better, you can progress to faster ones. And that's a very simple and enjoyable way of practicing your oral fluency- your physical fluency. OK, so I'm gonna move on now to another way of doing this. And this is by using 'tongue twisters'. So tongue twisters are sequences of words or sounds that are quite difficult to pronounce quickly and correctly. So here are some examples. There's 'Sally sells seashells by the seashore'. And then here's one that's quite famous in England, 'Peter Piper picked a peck of pickled peppers'. And this is quite a difficult one- 'Red leather, yellow leather'. So you can find lots of tongue twisters online and you can practice them on your own somewhere. And you should concentrate on the sound, not on the meaning because they don't really mean very much. And also you should choose tongue twisters that contain English sounds that you find hard to pronounce. OK, now I'm going to move now to talk about developing mental fluency.

OK. So here we've got two sets of skills that you need to develop. There is production skills, which is the ability to find the words in your mind and assemble them into sentences and phrases. And interaction skills which is the ability to respond to the reactions of the person that you're talking to. And again this is something that you do very very easily in your own language but it can be quite difficult if it's a foreign language. Because you've got the words that you want to say and you are assembling the words in your mind but you also have to respond to what the person that you're talking to is saying. So for example, you might be telling them something and they say, 'sorry, I don't understand' or they say ah, that they change the subject and you've got to be prepared to respond to the person that you're talking to in real time.

Now before we think about ways of dealing with that, with this, let's think about vocabulary for a moment. Does your vocabulary notebook look rather like this, where you've got an English word and you've got alongside it the translation into your own language? In this case it's Greek. Now, this is learning through translation, OK. And words don't exist in isolation. If you're speaking to somebody and you're constantly trying to translate into your own language, then it's going to be very very slow. And if you find a word that you don't know then you're going to stop speaking and also it's gonna be very hard for the person who is listening to you to stay patient whilst you're constantly trying to find English words. So, what are we going to do about it?

Instead of learning language in individual words, you can learn what we call 'lexical chunks'. Now a 'chunk' is a large piece of something. And you can see there there's is a large piece of rock, a chunk of rock. And you can learn language in chunks.

So here are one or two chunks that we use in conversation. So, 'What I'm trying to say is' is a phrase that you can use if somebody does not understand you and you want to umm, you want to rephrase what you were trying to say. 'Sorry, I'm not with you'. This is a rather informal way of saying 'I'm sorry I don't really understand what you're saying'- and it's a way that you can ask someone to, to explain something again, to say something again. Sometimes, if a person interrupts you, you want to go back to the story or the topic that you were talking about earlier so you can say 'So, to get back to what I was saying earlier'. And then we've got a phrase here, 'what are you on about?' Now this is a rather, possibly rather rude phrase that you can use if you really do not understand what someone's saying- it's 'what are you talking about?', 'I really don't understand what you're trying to say'.

OK. So here we've got three responses to the question: 'What are you going to do in the summer holidays'. So 'I'm thinking of', 'I might just', or 'I'll probably'.

So if I ask you the question- 'what you going to do in the summer holidays?' you could use any of those phrases to introduce your plans. And this way you'll sound more natural than just saying 'I'm going to Thailand' or 'I'm staying at home'.

And finally, well you have to speak. Developing oral fluency is like practicing a sport, it's like practicing a musical instrument. And you can only get better, you can only improve by doing. So you should speak as much English as possible in lessons. You might feel a bit shy but it doesn't matter, don't be shy- just say what you want to say and don't be afraid of making mistakes. Because if you make a mistake, it's possible, the person you are talking to can always ask you to rephrase what you said, can always query it and you can repair the mistake. And you'll probably feel nervous but you just have to get used to it and as times goes on, you'll get better at it. And also, don't go straight back to your own language if you find a communication problem. Try to overcome it in English. So if a person says to you 'Sorry, I don't really understand what you mean', instead of reverting back to your first language, you can try to repair the misunderstanding but using English.

OK. So. In conclusion, there are two kinds of fluency. There's physical fluency and mental fluency. Physical fluency is just moving your vocal organs and you can do this by using songs and tongue twisters. Mental fluency remember is assembling the words in your mind and learning chunks of language such as the ones I talked about earlier. And for this you just have to practise, practise, practise. Don't be afraid of mistakes and don't immediately revert to your first language when you come across a problem.

OK so that's the end of my presentation. I hope you found it interesting and useful and thank you all very much for listening.

Note-taking in Lectures - Task 4

1.
Welcome everyone. I'm Phil from the Centre for English Language Learning and today's seminar workshop is an important one. We are talking about referencing and citation and why it's crucial to your success here at De Montfort University. You should now have already come across some examples of in-text referencing and reference lists from the texts you have read from your reading list. But what I would like to do today is to outline the reasons why we reference in academia. In the seminar following this talk, you will look at some examples of referencing and have a go yourself.

2.
The COVID19 pandemic has brought about great change in primary school education. One of these changes I mentioned in last week's lecture is the use of technology as a learning resource. Of course, school children already use computers and tablets for a lot of their school work because during the pandemic, schools were closed and all teaching went online. Those children whose families couldn't afford new technology, were provided with tablets or computers so that they could access learning platforms. But now, even though children are back at school, heads of schools and school boards have seen the usefulness of children using technology as a learning tool outside of the classroom. However, with this, some children do not benefit as much as others. Therefore, it is important to identify the pros and cons of children using learning platforms out of school time.

3.
Good morning everyone. Today, as you know, I am going to look at three learning methodologies used by teachers to teach English as a second language. I will explain what each method is and give some real examples of how teachers incorporate these into their teaching. Remember that you must include at least one of these methods into your lesson observation. Just a reminder, if you haven't already chosen your date and time of your observed lesson, please do so at the end of this lecture.

4.
It is a sad fact that many school children in the UK from low-income households do not often receive a nutritious hot meal at home and rely on free school meals. The seriousness of this situation was brought to light to the masses in 2021 when Marcus Rashford, a Manchester United professional footballer, campaigned successfully for schools to provide those free school meals during school holidays. In today's lecture, I will give you a brief history of how celebrities have used their status to campaign for change to educational policies in the UK.

Note-taking in Lectures- Task 1c

Welcome everyone. I'm Phil from the Centre for English Language Learning and today's seminar workshop is an important one. We are talking about referencing and citation and why it's crucial to your success here at De Montfort University. You should now have already come across some examples of in-text referencing and reference lists from the texts you have read from your reading list. But what I would like to do today is to outline the reasons why we reference in academia. In the seminar following this talk, you will look at some examples of referencing and have a go yourself.

So, what's the point of referencing and citing sources? Well there are many reasons. The first reason is that it's good academic research practice and helps us to avoid plagiarism. Put simply, if you use someone else's work and don't include a reference in your work, you are committing an academic offense. You could fail an assessment, a module or even your course so it really is imperative that you do it.

Well some students might say 'OK, I won't use anyone else's ideas, I'll just use my own ideas and then I don't need to reference'. This would be a really bad idea. Referencing and citing your sources means that you can show and prove to your lecturer that you have considered the research and thoughts of others. It simply is not enough to give your own opinions. Yes, give your opinions, but these must be supported with ideas from others. And when you include support, you must include a reference. You really can't get away with not doing it if you want to get decent grades.

The third point to consider is that as part of your assessment, your lecturers will want to know how much you have read on the topic in order to complete your assignment. This is not just for written assignments but for things like presentations too. They need to see that you have explored a range of texts suitable for giving a well-balanced argument supported by the work of other researchers in the field. The only way you can do this is to include an in-text citation, such as a paraphrase, an in-text reference and an entry in the reference list. So again, referencing is a really crucial element of studying at university.

The fourth point is related to critical thinking. You will hear lecturers again and again say 'you need to think critically'. And to be honest, it can be hard to know what to actually do. But, through the in-text references, you are able to show that you can think critically. For example, you can show which researchers agree with each other or those that disagree, and even those that agree or disagree with you. You can also show links between ideas which is what we call 'synthesising' and it is this skill that can really boost you from having a competent piece of writing to an advanced level assignment worthy of a first-class mark. We will look at how to do this in later seminars.

So I hope this goes some way to explaining why in British culture we put so much emphasis on referencing. Now I would like to just remind you of how we actually do it. So as you can see here…

Note-taking in Lectures- Improving Education- Task 2c

The COVID19 pandemic has brought about great change in primary school education. One of these changes I mentioned in last week's lecture is the use of technology as a learning resource. Of course, school children already use computers and tablets for a lot of their school work because during the pandemic, schools were closed and all teaching went online. Those children whose families couldn't afford new technology, were provided with tablets or computers so that they could access learning platforms. But now, even though children are back at school, heads of schools and school boards have seen the usefulness of children using technology as a learning tool outside of the classroom. However, with this, some children do not benefit as much as others. Therefore, it is important to identify the pros and cons of children using learning platforms out of school time.

So let's begin by talking about the positive aspects of children using learning platforms. One advantage is that children are given an online account. Through these accounts, they can access learning resources at any time they like. As a result, with their teacher's guidance, pupils can develop autonomy and are able to decide for themselves when to study and what to study. This is of course something that students at university level certainly have to do and many undergraduate students struggle with this new-found academic freedom, so encouraging school pupils to develop independence at an early age can only be beneficial.

Likewise, another benefit is that children can develop their digital literacy skills. Children even at primary school level, through learning platforms such as Fronter, See Saw and Century, can learn to share files with one another, discuss ideas in closed forums, complete homework tasks and write blogs. All of the skills involved in doing these activities prepare pupils for life and work that is constantly becoming more reliant on computers.

My final advantage of using learning platforms is to do with confidence. By this, I mean that children develop their confidence in the subject they are learning. In class, children have to go at the pace of the teacher or of their classmates. However, at home, if the student's homework is to watch a video on a subject, they can watch multiple times, rewind and fast forward and spend as much time as they like to understand the information. As an effect, they can develop confidence in themselves at being able to complete tasks and in turn could help their attainment in that subject.

While there are some clear advantages of using learning platforms out of school, I would like to now move on to talking about the negatives, which you will notice all refer to money. Obviously, providing IT equipment and paying for school subscriptions to learning platforms is expensive for governments and trusts to finance but what I would like to focus on here is the implications for the children from low-income backgrounds. The first point to note is that…

Mobile Phone Use in Education- Task 6

Part 1

Hi everyone. My name is Sophia Mavridi and I'm a digital learning specialist and a lecturer at De Montfort University. This mini lecture today is about digital distractions. It is not against technology. In fact, I'm going to argue that technology is a very important resource in education and that devices should not be banned from the classroom. At the same time, I'm going to point out that students need to develop skills and competences to manage their digital distractions.

So, technology has changed learning and teaching for good. We can find information

at the click of a button and use it for our research, share files, photos, we can collaborate with other students outside the classroom using Skype or Zoom or other video conferencing tools. So technology can open the door to so many opportunities.

However, along with this massive potential, technology is also chronically distracting us. Teachers are concerned about students' digital distractions. They say that they use their phones as a quick route to Instagram or Facebook during a lesson and surprisingly students that meet that it is very difficult for them to stay focused because of the various distractions around them- digital distractions.

So a relatively recent study on students' perceptions of digital distractions, it was published in 2016, asked around 700 college students in 26 States of America. So about 97% of students use their devices in class between 1 to 30+ times a day for non-class purposes; for example, for social media, texts or other non-class purposes. Around 63% tune out to fight boredom or to stay connected. And around 89% of these students say that using their devices distracts them, so they admit that devices can be distracting. So these college students said that one of the leading reasons that they use their devices in class for non-class purposes is because they want to stay connected.

Some people refer to this over use of digital devices, to this constant need to stay connected, as an addiction. But there is no evidence to support such classification and it is a medical term- addiction is a medical term- and it should be used very carefully. A more accurate term is 'FOMO'- fear of missing out, which is a form of anxiety that borders on obsession or compulsion. The fast pace of the virtual world is exciting and offers instant gratification, instant stimulation and pleasure. And this is one of the reasons why people are so attached to their devices. This is definitely something that we need to consider when we look into the issue and when we try to find solutions. We are used to this instant gratification and the offline world might feel less exciting than the online world.

We're now hardly surprised to see people walking down the street looking at their phones. Some call them the 'distracted generation' or even 'smartphone zombies'- people who have their eyes glued to their phones and their screens worried about missing out, feeling uncomfortable after some minutes without this gratification, without connectivity. So this is FOMO and it can have an impact on both your behaviour and learning.

Mobile Phone Use in Education- Task 7

Part 2

Hello everyone this is Sophia Mavridi from De Montfort University and this is Part 2 of a mini-lecture on digital distractions.

So how do distractions and FOMO affect us? Well they can affect is in so many ways but I'm only going to talk about your learning here. A study on people's productivity found that it takes about 25 minutes to get back into the swing of things. After you've been distracted- 25 minutes to really get back in the zone. This is quite serious. Also, studies do show that when students are distracted, they have a difficult time learning new things, and this can have a negative effect on their learning and grades.

But just because technology is distracting us doesn't mean that we should ban it. In fact, we shouldn't because devices from the classroom means depriving students of the opportunity to develop this 21st century skill in the context of learning- because managing digital distractions is a 21st century skill. It is a literacy like reading and writing. And you need to develop these skills along with other skills because it reflects the way people learn and live in the 21st century. You may be good at using social media or creating videos or adding filters to photos but these, as you can see in the framework, is only a small part of digital literacy. So what you really need is to develop skills and competences to manage digital distractions in the class and at home.

So, over to you. What techniques can you think of that can help you to manage the way you use your devices? What can we do to take advantage of technology without letting it be a distraction? Have a look at the references if you want to explore further but think about the last question I asked you. Thank you.

Strengths and Weaknesses- Task 2

Part 1

Andrew	Hi Haoran, how's it going?
Haoran	I've made some notes
Andrew	OK, can you share your screen?
Haoran	Yeah… OK, can you see?
Andrew	Yes, thank you. Let's have a look. You've only written bad things!
Haoran	Yes.
Andrew	Can you tell me some areas that you feel you made progress in?
Hoaran	I er… I don't know.
Andrew	Well, you did a great presentation, didn't you?
Haoran	Ye…ah. I don't know. I don't know if it was OK or not
Andrew	Don't you remember what I said was good about your presentation?
Haoran	The slides?
Andrew	Yes, the slides were good but think about what you said.
Haoran	You said I practised well.
Andrew	Yeah, you did, and your speaking was very clear and the organisation of the ideas was great. You've made progress there, right? You know now that you need to organise your presentations and practise by yourself before you do it in class. That way you can be successful and you won't feel so nervous.
Haoran	Yeah, OK.
Andrew	And I've noticed that your writing is pretty good sometimes as well.
Haoran	It's good?
Andrew	Yeah, some of the stuff you wrote in the forum was very good, very clear.
Haoran	I'm confused about grammar sometimes. Many mistakes!
Andrew	Yes, there were a few, but nothing serious because everyone understood and quite a few people wanted to reply, because you made some good points. So think about communication and don't worry about mistakes too much. I don't think you particularly struggle with grammar. Did you prepare your forum answers or just type them straight away?
Haoran	Err… I prepare them, yeah. Then ed… ed…
Andrew	Edit?
Haoran	Edit, yeah.
Andrew	So, it seems when you study you like to prepare things carefully, to think about them before you say anything, or write anything?
Haoran	Yes! So in groups, speaking, I'm not good, I can't prepare. Very nervous, I don't want to make mistakes.
Andrew	Well speaking in groups is different to a presentation because in a group you have to respond to what other people say, and you often don't know what they are going to say, so you can't really prepare. Do you remember some of the phrases we learned?
Haoran	Yeah, like, 'give me a moment' 'let me think'
Andrew	'Can I come in here?' 'I'm sorry, I didn't quite catch that'. They can give you time to think, and stop others interrupting you.

Part 2

OK, so here are a few things you can do to reflect on your learning. First, at the end of each lesson, take a few minutes to think 'what did I learn today? What was difficult? What went well?' You could keep a small notebook, or use your phone to write two or three sentences about your progress each week. Remember, don't just say 'speaking is hard' 'learning vocabulary is difficult – try to say why. So, for example, 'I forget the words I want to use' or 'there are just too many words sometimes'. Then you can choose one thing that you want to improve next time, you know, like 'I'll try to use two new words in class' or 'I'll try to ask at least one question in a discussion'. A week or so later, you can look at your notes again and ask yourself 'did I improve? What helped me most?' And it's really important to think about how you learn best – don't just think 'this is hard', 'I'm really bad at this' – think about how you can help yourself, and about who can help you, and also about the things you can do well.

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